IMPULSE
Learning Center

Speaking Mock



Milliy sertifikat · CEFR

# Multilevel

Speaking: **34 Mock Tests**

Part 1.1 · 1.2 · 2 · 3 · C1 model answers

MULTILEVEL · CEFR

# HOW TO USE THIS BOOK

**34 speaking tests**
Questions + C1 model answers

This book contains **34 complete Multilevel speaking tests** in the real exam format, each followed by **C1-level model answers**. Practise like the real exam: set a timer, speak out loud and record yourself.

### ⏱️ Use a timer
Keep to the real timings: 5–10 s to prepare in Part 1, 1 minute in Parts 2 and 3.

### 📱 Record yourself
Record every answer on your phone, then listen back. Check your fluency, grammar and range of vocabulary.

### ⭐ Compare with the model
Each test is followed by C1 model answers. Note the useful phrases and try to use them next time.

### 🔁 Repeat
Answer the same test again a few days later and compare the two recordings.

### 🎧 Examiner audio
Listen to the examiner questions in our Telegram channel and answer in real time.

### 🎧 Examiner audio
Scan the QR code to open our Telegram channel.

t.me/multilevel_express

| Part | Task | Questions | Preparation | Speaking |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1.1 | Personal questions | 3 | 5 s | 30 s |
| 1.2 | Two pictures: describe and compare | 3 | 5–10 s | 30–45 s |
| 2 | Long turn with a cue card | 1 | 1 min | 2 min |
| 3 | For and against discussion | 1 | 1 min | 2 min |

| Test set | Tests |
|---|---|
| Real Exam 2026 · Set A | Tests 1–10 |
| Real Exam 2026 · Set B | Tests 11–20 |
| Speaking Mock Book | Tests 21–34 |

MULTILEVEL · SPEAKING

# TEST 1

**Real Exam 2026 · Set A**

Home and evenings · Healthy food and fast food · Sharing a secret · Calorie information in restaurants

## PART 1.1 — Personal questions

🎙️ **Answer the questions about yourself. Speak for about 30 seconds each.**

**1** Do you live in a house or in a flat?
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

**2** What do you usually do in the evening?
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

**3** Do you like cooking?
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

## PART 1.2 — Compare two pictures

🖼️ **Look at the two pictures and answer the questions.**





**4** What do you see in these pictures?
⏱ 10 s · 🎙 45 s

**5** What is the biggest difficulty people face in keeping to a healthy diet?
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

**6** How can we encourage more people to eat healthy food?
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

## PART 2 — Long turn

🗣️ **Look at the picture and talk about the topic. You have 1 minute to prepare and 2 minutes to speak.**



**Talk about:**

- Describe a time when you shared a secret with someone.
- Why did you decide to share it with that person?
- How important is trust between people?

⏱ 1 min · 🎙 2 min

## PART 3 — Discussion

⚖️ **Give a balanced argument for and against the statement, then give your own opinion. 1 minute to prepare, 2 minutes to speak.**

**"Fast-food restaurants should display the number of calories in their meals."**

| FOR | AGAINST |
|---|---|
| helps people make an informed choice about what they eat | most customers ignore the numbers anyway |
| encourages restaurants to offer healthier options | can create anxiety and guilt around food |
| could reduce obesity and diet-related illness | calories say nothing about the real nutritional value |

⏱ 1 min · 🎙 2 min

**1 Part 1.1 Do you live in a house or in a flat?**

I live in a flat at the moment, and although it is not very spacious, I really like it because it is practical, easy to clean, and perfectly suitable for my daily routine and the way I live now.

**2 Part 1.1 What do you usually do in the evening?**

In the evening, I usually relax after work or study, have dinner, and then spend some time on my phone, reading messages, watching a series, or just doing a bit of nothing to switch off properly.

**3 Part 1.1 Do you like cooking?**

Yes, I do enjoy cooking, especially simple home-style meals. I'm not an expert, but I like it because it helps me relax, and I also feel more in control of what I eat and how healthy it is.

**4 Part 1.2 What do you see in these pictures?**

In the first picture, I can see a woman sitting at a table and preparing a fresh salad. There are lots of fruits and vegetables around her, including bananas, oranges, broccoli, and other healthy-looking food. In the second picture, there is a man eating fast food, such as burgers, fries, doughnuts, and fried chicken. The contrast is very strong: one image suggests a balanced lifestyle, while the other shows overeating and much less healthy food.

**5 Part 1.2 What is the biggest difficulty people face in keeping to a healthy diet?**

I think the biggest difficulty is self-control, because most people already know what they should eat, but they often choose convenience instead. Fast food is quick, cheap, and tasty, so when people are busy, tired, or stressed, they find it hard to say no. Another problem is habit: once someone gets used to unhealthy food, it becomes difficult to change their routine.

**6 Part 1.2 How can we encourage more people to eat healthy food?**

I think we can encourage healthy eating by making it easier and more attractive. For example, healthy food should be available everywhere, and it should not cost much more than junk food. Schools and workplaces could also promote balanced meals, and social media campaigns could show that healthy food can be tasty, simple, and satisfying rather than boring and unrealistic.

**7 Part 2 Describe a time when you shared a secret with someone.**

I remember sharing a secret with my closest friend at university, and it was one of those moments when I really understood what trust means. At that time, I had been offered a small scholarship to study abroad, but I had not told my family yet because I was worried about their reaction. I knew it was good news, but I also knew it could create pressure, so I wanted to think carefully before speaking to them. I decided to tell my best friend first, because she had always been honest, calm, and discreet. She never spread other people's private information, and I felt completely safe with her. When I told her, she listened carefully, asked a few sensible questions, and then helped me see the situation more clearly. She didn't judge me at all, which made me feel a lot better. After that, I had the confidence to explain everything to my family. Looking back, that experience showed me that trust is essential in any close relationship. If people trust each other, they can share worries, ask for advice, and be themselves. Without trust, even a friendship or family relationship can become weak and insecure.

**8 Part 3 Fast-food restaurants should display the number of calories in their meals.**

The question is whether fast-food restaurants should display the number of calories in their meals. I strongly believe they should, because this information can help people make more informed choices about what they eat. When customers can see the calorie content clearly, they are more likely to compare options and decide whether they really want a large burger, fries, and a sugary drink, or something lighter. In that sense, calorie labels can also push restaurants to think more seriously about health and to offer better alternatives. If this becomes normal, it could contribute to lower obesity levels and fewer diet-related illnesses in the long run. However, there are also some valid arguments against the idea. Some people simply ignore calorie numbers, so the labels may not change behaviour much. Others may become anxious or guilty about food, which is not healthy either, especially for people who already have a difficult relationship with eating. Another important point is that calories are only one part of the picture. A meal can be low in calories but still poor in nutrients, or high in calories but quite nutritious. My own view is that calorie information should definitely be shown, but it should be presented clearly and sensibly, without making people feel judged. It is a useful guide, not the whole answer, and it works best when people also learn about nutrition more broadly.

MULTILEVEL · SPEAKING

# TEST 2

**Real Exam 2026 · Set A**

Sport and your town · Paying in cash and by card · A time you felt powerful · A four-day working week

## PART 1.1 — Personal questions

🎙️ **Answer the questions about yourself. Speak for about 30 seconds each.**

**1** Tell me about a sport that you play or watch.
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

**2** What do you like most about your town?
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

**3** Who is your favourite sportsperson?
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

## PART 1.2 — Compare two pictures

🖼️ **Look at the two pictures and answer the questions.**





**4** What do you see in these pictures?
⏱ 10 s · 🎙 45 s

**5** Why do some people prefer paying by card?
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

**6** What are the advantages of paying in cash?
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

## PART 2 — Long turn

🗣️ **Look at the picture and talk about the topic. You have 1 minute to prepare and 2 minutes to speak.**



**Talk about:**

- Describe a time when you felt powerful.
- What exactly gave you that feeling?
- Do you think having power changes the way people behave?

⏱ 1 min · 🎙 2 min

## PART 3 — Discussion

⚖️ **Give a balanced argument for and against the statement, then give your own opinion. 1 minute to prepare, 2 minutes to speak.**

**"Employees should work only four days a week."**

| FOR | AGAINST |
|---|---|
| rested workers are more productive in fewer hours | many services must operate five or six days a week |
| more time for family, study and personal health | the same workload is squeezed into longer days |
| fewer working days mean less commuting and pollution | small businesses may lose income and customers |

⏱ 1 min · 🎙 2 min

## MODEL ANSWERS

C1 model answers

**1 Part 1.1 Tell me about a sport that you play or watch.**

I often play football, and I also enjoy watching it whenever I have the chance. For me, it is one of the most exciting sports because every match feels different, and there is always something unpredictable happening. It also teaches teamwork, discipline, and quick decision-making. When I play with my friends after school, I feel active, competitive, and completely distracted from daily stress.

**2 Part 1.1 What do you like most about your town?**

What I like most about my town is the friendly atmosphere and the fact that life feels comfortable there. People usually greet each other, so it does not feel cold or anonymous. I also like the parks and small streets, because they give the town a calm, relaxed feeling. Another thing I appreciate is that most places I need are nearby, so daily life is practical and easy.

**3 Part 1.1 Who is your favourite sportsperson?**

My favourite sportsperson is Cristiano Ronaldo. I admire him not just because he is talented, but because he has stayed at the highest level for such a long time. His discipline, fitness, and determination are impressive, and he always seems to push himself further. For me, he is a good example of what hard work and self-belief can achieve in sport.

**4 Part 1.2 What do you see in these pictures?**

In the first picture, a woman is holding a fan of banknotes in front of her face, and she is looking to the side. In the second picture, a customer is paying with a credit card at a payment terminal. The first image feels more private and focused on cash, while the second one shows a modern, everyday card payment. Both pictures are about money, but they present two different ways of paying for things.

**5 Part 1.2 Why do some people prefer paying by card?**

Some people prefer paying by card because it is quick, practical, and easy to manage. They do not need to carry much cash, and they can make a payment in seconds, especially when they are in a hurry. Card payments are also useful for online shopping and contactless purchases. In addition, many people like that their transactions are recorded automatically, so it is easier to keep track of spending.

**6 Part 1.2 What are the advantages of paying in cash?**

The main advantage of paying in cash is that it is simple and accepted almost everywhere. You do not need a phone, a card reader, or an internet connection, so it can be more reliable in small shops or when technology fails. Cash also helps some people control their budget better, because once the money is gone, they know they have spent it. That can make them more careful.

**7 Part 2 Describe a time when you felt powerful.**

I remember feeling powerful when I helped organise a school event last year. At first, everything seemed messy and out of control: some people were late, the decorations were not ready, and nobody really knew what to do next. I was nervous too, but I decided to take responsibility. I made a simple plan, divided the tasks, and told each person exactly what they should focus on. Slowly, the whole situation became calmer and more organised. What gave me that feeling was not physical strength, but the chance to influence what was happening and make a real difference. For the first time, I felt that my decisions mattered and that other people were depending on me. It was exciting because I could see the results immediately. Yes, I do think having power changes the way people behave. Some people become more confident, calm, and responsible because they know others trust them. However, others may become arrogant, bossy, or careless if they start enjoying control too much. So in my opinion, power reveals character, and it can improve or damage behaviour depending on the person.

**8 Part 3 Employees should work only four days a week.**

I think the idea of a four-day working week is very interesting, but it is not simple. On the one hand, there are clear advantages. If employees are rested, they are often more productive in fewer hours because they concentrate better and make fewer mistakes. A shorter week also means more time for family, study, exercise, and general health, which can improve people's quality of life. Another benefit is that fewer working days can reduce commuting, traffic jams, and pollution, so there is also an environmental advantage. On the other hand, there are serious disadvantages. Many services, such as hospitals, shops, restaurants, and public transport, still need to operate five or six days a week, so the idea does not suit every sector. In addition, the same workload may simply be squeezed into longer, more tiring days, which could cancel out the benefit of extra rest. Small businesses may also suffer if they have fewer opening days or lose customers. Personally, I support the idea only in some jobs. I think office workers and people with flexible schedules could benefit a lot, but the system should not be copied blindly everywhere.

MULTILEVEL · SPEAKING

# TEST 3

**Real Exam 2026 · Set A**

Hobbies and music · Watching television and playing board games · A person close to you · Children and mobile phones

## PART 1.1 — Personal questions

**Answer the questions about yourself. Speak for about 30 seconds each.**

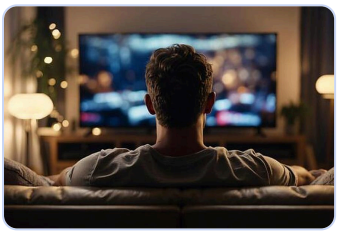
**1** What is your hobby?
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

**2** Which part of the day do you like the most?
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

**3** What kind of music do you like?
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

## PART 1.2 — Compare two pictures

**Look at the two pictures and answer the questions.**





**4** What do you see in these pictures?
⏱ 10 s · 🎙 45 s

**5** What are the advantages of playing board games together?
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

**6** Why do many families prefer watching television in the evening?
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

## PART 2 — Long turn

**Look at the picture and talk about the topic. You have 1 minute to prepare and 2 minutes to speak.**



**Talk about:**

- Describe a person who is very close to you.
- How did you first meet this person?
- Why is that person so important in your life?

⏱ 1 min · 🎙 2 min

## PART 3 — Discussion

**Give a balanced argument for and against the statement, then give your own opinion. 1 minute to prepare, 2 minutes to speak.**

**"Children should spend far less time on mobile phones."**

| FOR | AGAINST |
|---|---|
| protects eyesight, sleep and physical activity | phones are now a normal learning and study tool |
| more real conversation with family and friends | parents need a way to stay in contact with children |
| less exposure to harmful or unsuitable content | the problem is how phones are used, not the time itself |

⏱ 1 min · 🎙 2 min

## MODEL ANSWERS — C1 model answers

**1 Part 1.1 What is your hobby?**

My hobby is reading books, especially novels and short stories, because I really enjoy getting lost in a good plot and following how the characters change. It helps me relax after a busy day, and at the same time I learn new words, new expressions, and sometimes even new ways of thinking from the stories.

**2** **Part 1.1** **Which part of the day do you like the most?**

I like the evening the most, because that is usually the only time when I can slow down and breathe after a busy day. I finish my lessons or other responsibilities, have dinner with my family, and then do something calm like reading, listening to music, or simply resting quietly without any pressure.

**3** **Part 1.1** **What kind of music do you like?**

I like a mix of music, but mostly I enjoy pop and soft instrumental songs, because they are pleasant, easy to listen to, and not too distracting. They help me concentrate when I study, and they also improve my mood when I feel tired, stressed, or a little bored.

**4** **Part 1.2** **What do you see in these pictures?**

In the first picture, I can see a man sitting on a sofa and watching television in a dark living room, with the screen as the main source of light. In the second picture, there is a family sitting around a board game at a table, smiling and holding cards. The first scene looks quiet and individual, while the second one looks more lively, interactive, and clearly shared.

**5** **Part 1.2** **What are the advantages of playing board games together?**

The main advantage is that board games bring people together in a very natural way, because everyone has to sit, talk, and take part in the same activity. They help family members laugh, share emotions, and spend real time with each other instead of looking at separate screens. They can also teach children patience, cooperation, and how to accept winning or losing gracefully.

**6** **Part 1.2** **Why do many families prefer watching television in the evening?**

Many families prefer watching television in the evening because it is a simple and comfortable way to relax after a long day at work or school. Everyone can sit together in one room without much effort, and it gives them a chance to enjoy the same programme, talk a little, and wind down before going to bed. For many people, it becomes a familiar daily routine.

**7** **Part 2** **Describe a person who is very close to you.**

The person I'm closest to is my older sister, because she is not just my sister but also my best adviser and one of the few people who really understands me. I can talk to her about my studies, my worries, or even very small things that bother me, and she always listens seriously instead of judging me. That makes me feel supported and safe. We first became really close when I was about ten years old. At that time, I had to change schools, and I felt nervous, lonely, and a little lost in the new environment. She noticed that I was struggling, and she spent a lot of time with me, helping me settle in and feel more confident. Since then, our relationship has only grown stronger. She is very important in my life because she gives me honest advice and encourages me whenever I doubt myself. For example, when I was preparing for an important exam, she studied with me in the evening, tested me, and kept me motivated. I honestly think having someone like that is a real blessing, and I know I can always depend on her when life becomes difficult.

**8** **Part 3** **Children should spend far less time on mobile phones.**

I strongly agree that children should spend far less time on mobile phones. To begin with, too much screen time can damage eyesight, disturb sleep, and reduce physical activity, which are all important for a child's healthy development. If children are always looking at a screen, they move less, sit in one position for too long, and often feel tired or distracted during the day. Another important point is that phones can replace real conversation. When children are always online, they may talk less with their parents and friends face to face, and that can weaken relationships over time. There is also the issue of harmful or unsuitable content, because the internet contains videos, ads, and messages that are not always appropriate for young users. However, I can understand the opposite view too. Phones are now a normal learning and study tool, because children use them for homework, dictionaries, online classes, and educational apps. Parents also need a quick way to contact their children, especially when they are outside the home or travelling somewhere. In my opinion, the real problem is not the phone itself, but how it is used and whether children have clear limits. Even so, I believe children need much less screen time, because their health, attention, and real-life relationships are more important than constant access to a phone, and good habits formed early usually stay with them for life.

MULTILEVEL · SPEAKING

# TEST 4

**Real Exam 2026 · Set A**

Family, books and films · Writing by hand and typing · An uncertain situation · Homework

## PART 1.1 — Personal questions

🎙️ **Answer the questions about yourself. Speak for about 30 seconds each.**

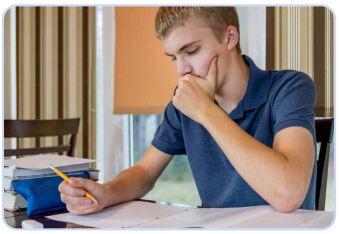
**1** Do you have a large family?
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

**2** How often do you read books?
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

**3** Do you have a favourite actor or actress?
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

## PART 1.2 — Compare two pictures

🖼️ **Look at the two pictures and answer the questions.**





**4** What do you see in these pictures?
⏱ 10 s · 🎙 45 s

**5** What are the advantages of writing by hand?
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

**6** Why do most students now prefer typing on a computer?
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

## PART 2 — Long turn

🗣️ **Look at the picture and talk about the topic. You have 1 minute to prepare and 2 minutes to speak.**



**Talk about:**

- Describe a situation when you did not know what to do.
- How did you finally make your decision?
- How do people usually behave when their future is uncertain?

⏱ 1 min · 🎙 2 min

## PART 3 — Discussion

⚖️ **Give a balanced argument for and against the statement, then give your own opinion. 1 minute to prepare, 2 minutes to speak.**

**"Homework should be abolished in schools."**

| FOR | AGAINST |
|---|---|
| children need rest, sport and family time after lessons | practice at home fixes what was taught in class |
| homework increases stress and copying instead of learning | teaches independence, planning and self-discipline |
| not every family can help with difficult tasks at home | prepares students for university and for exams |

⏱ 1 min · 🎙 2 min

**1 Part 1.1 Do you have a large family?**

Yes, I do, and I think having a large family is a real advantage because there is always someone to talk to, ask advice from, or simply spend time with when you want company. In my family, we often eat together and discuss our day, so the house rarely feels empty or boring, even when everyone is busy with their own plans.

**2 Part 1.1 How often do you read books?**

I read books quite often, although not every single day. Usually I read in the evening or at weekends, when I finally have enough quiet time to concentrate properly. I like books because they help me relax after a busy day and, at the same time, they give me new ideas, useful vocabulary, and different ways of thinking.

**3 Part 1.1 Do you have a favourite actor or actress?**

Yes, I do. My favourite actor is Leonardo DiCaprio because he can play very different roles convincingly, from serious dramas to more adventurous films, and he always seems believable. I also respect him because he appears to choose projects carefully, not just whatever is most popular, and that makes him interesting to follow over time.

**4 Part 1.2 What do you see in these pictures?**

In the first picture, a young man is sitting at a table and writing with a pencil. He looks thoughtful and a little worried, and there are books, papers, and a pencil case in front of him. In the second picture, another boy is sitting at a computer in what looks like a classroom or computer lab. The contrast is clear: one is working by hand, while the other is using a keyboard and screen.

**5 Part 1.2 What are the advantages of writing by hand?**

Writing by hand has several advantages. First, it can help people remember information better because the slower process makes them think more carefully about what they are writing and how they express it. It can also improve handwriting and spelling, which is useful in school and in daily life. Besides that, it does not depend on electricity, internet, or devices, so it is always available anywhere.

**6 Part 1.2 Why do most students now prefer typing on a computer?**

Most students prefer typing because it is faster and more convenient, especially for longer assignments or notes that need to be finished quickly. On a computer, they can correct mistakes quickly, move text around, and make the final version look neat and professional. Typing is also practical because it saves time and makes it easier to store, share, and print work when needed, which is very useful today.

**7 Part 2 Describe a situation when you did not know what to do.**

A situation when I did not know what to do happened last year before an important school exam. I had revised a lot, but on the evening before the exam I suddenly realised that I had forgotten one whole topic, and that made me panic for a while because I did not want to fail. I kept thinking about whether I should try to learn everything or just focus on the most important points, and I honestly felt stuck. In the end, I decided not to waste time on impossible plans. I sat down, made a quick list of what I already knew, and then checked the syllabus to see which areas were most likely to appear in the exam. After that, I called a classmate and asked him to explain one difficult part over the phone. That small conversation helped me calm down, organise my thoughts, and concentrate properly again. People usually behave in different ways when their future is uncertain. Some become nervous, indecisive, and emotional, while others try to stay calm and organise their next steps carefully. In my opinion, the best reaction is to accept uncertainty, think logically, and do the things that are still under your control. That is what gives you confidence and reduces stress.

**8 Part 3 Homework should be abolished in schools.**

The statement that homework should be abolished in schools is a very debatable one, and I can understand why people disagree. On the one hand, supporters of this idea say that children already spend many hours studying in class, so they need time after lessons to rest, play sport, and be with their families. They also argue that homework often increases stress and, in some cases, leads to copying instead of real learning, which defeats the purpose completely. Another serious point is that not every family can help with difficult tasks at home, so homework may put some children at a disadvantage and make the gap between students wider. On the other hand, homework also has clear educational value. Practice at home helps students consolidate what was taught in class, especially in subjects that require repetition, revision, and steady progress. It also teaches independence, planning, and self-discipline, because students must organise their time without constant supervision from teachers. In addition, regular homework prepares them for university study and for exams, where self-study becomes essential and nobody checks every step. Personally, I would not abolish homework completely, but I would reduce it and make it more meaningful. A small amount of well-designed homework can be useful, while too much of it becomes exhausting, unfair, and ineffective. So, in my view, schools should improve homework, not remove it entirely.

MULTILEVEL · SPEAKING

# TEST 5

**Real Exam 2026 · Set A**

Work, study and free time · Local markets and supermarkets · An important decision · Free university education

## PART 1.1 — Personal questions

**Answer the questions about yourself. Speak for about 30 seconds each.**

1. **Do you work or do you study?**
   ⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s
2. **Where do you like to go in your free time?**
   ⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s
3. **Do you have a lot of friends?**
   ⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

## PART 1.2 — Compare two pictures

**Look at the two pictures and answer the questions.**






4. **What do you see in these pictures?**
   ⏱ 10 s · 🎙 45 s
5. **What are the advantages of shopping at a local market?**
   ⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s
6. **Why do so many people prefer supermarkets these days?**
   ⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

## PART 2 — Long turn

**Look at the picture and talk about the topic. You have 1 minute to prepare and 2 minutes to speak.**



**Talk about:**

- Tell me about an important decision that you have made.
- How has this decision influenced your life?
- What has the greatest effect on the decisions that people make?

⏱ 1 min · 🎙 2 min

## PART 3 — Discussion

**Give a balanced argument for and against the statement, then give your own opinion. 1 minute to prepare, 2 minutes to speak.**

**"University education should be free for everyone."**

| FOR | AGAINST |
|---|---|
| talented students are not stopped by their family income | a very heavy cost for the state budget and taxpayers |
| a better educated population helps the whole economy | free places may be taken by unmotivated students |
| reduces inequality between rich and poor regions | quality can fall when universities are underfunded |

⏱ 1 min · 🎙 2 min

**1 Part 1.1 Do you work or do you study?**

I'm a student at the moment, so I spend most of my time studying, although I also try to build useful skills outside class. At the moment, I'm focusing on my future and on choosing the right direction for my career, which is why I take my studies seriously and try to stay organised every day.

**2 Part 1.1 Where do you like to go in your free time?**

In my free time, I usually like going to places where I can relax and clear my head, such as a park, a café, or sometimes a sports ground with friends. I enjoy a calm atmosphere after a busy week, because it helps me recover, think more clearly, and come back with more energy and a better mood.

**3 Part 1.1 Do you have a lot of friends?**

Yes, I do, and I'm lucky to have a fairly close circle of friends. I don't need a huge number of them, because the most important thing for me is trust and honesty, not quantity. A few reliable people are much better than many casual acquaintances, in my opinion, because they are there when it really matters.

**4 Part 1.2 What do you see in these pictures?**

In the first picture, I can see a man selling fresh food at a local market, with vegetables, bread, eggs and fruit arranged around him very neatly. In the second picture, a woman is shopping in a supermarket and choosing a packet from a shelf while holding a basket. The market looks more personal and colourful, while the supermarket seems more organised and convenient. They both show people buying food, but in very different settings.

**5 Part 1.2 What are the advantages of shopping at a local market?**

One big advantage is freshness. At a local market, you can often buy fruit, vegetables and other products that are produced nearby, so they can taste better and feel more natural. Another benefit is direct contact with sellers: you can ask questions, negotiate the price, and sometimes get advice about what to choose. Also, shopping there often supports small farmers and local businesses, which is good for the community.

**6 Part 1.2 Why do so many people prefer supermarkets these days?**

Many people prefer supermarkets because they save time and effort. Everything is in one place, so you can buy food, household items and other products quickly and easily without visiting several shops. Supermarkets also offer fixed prices, long opening hours and a wide choice of brands, which makes shopping simpler. For busy people, that combination of convenience and predictability is very attractive indeed.

**7 Part 2 Tell me about an important decision that you have made.**

One important decision I have made was to choose a field of study that really matched my interests instead of simply following other people's advice. At one point, I was unsure whether to pick something practical or something I personally enjoyed more, but I finally chose the subject that I felt most motivated to study. It was not the easiest choice, because I knew it would affect my career path, but I wanted to make a decision based on my own goals and interests.

This decision has influenced my life in a very positive way. First, it has made me more responsible, because I now understand that my future depends a lot on the choices I make today. Second, I feel more interested in my studies, which means I work harder and learn more naturally. I remember telling my family about my choice, and although they had some concerns at first, they later supported me when they saw how serious I was. That support gave me extra confidence and helped me keep going.

In my opinion, the greatest effect on people's decisions is a combination of their personal values and their circumstances. For example, family expectations, money, and opportunities can strongly shape what someone chooses, but in the end, confidence and clear goals also matter a great deal. If people know what they really want and understand the realities around them, they usually make better decisions, even when life is complicated and uncertain.

**8 Part 3 University education should be free for everyone.**

I think this is a very important question, because university education affects both individuals and society as a whole. On the one hand, making university free would give talented students a real chance, even if their families do not have much money. It would also help create a better educated population, which usually leads to stronger economic growth. In addition, it could reduce the gap between richer and poorer regions, because more young people would be able to study and later improve their communities in practical ways.

On the other hand, free education is extremely expensive, so the state and taxpayers would have to pay a very heavy price. There is also a risk that some students would take free places without being truly motivated, which can reduce efficiency. Another concern is quality: if universities are underfunded, they may not have good teachers, facilities, or research opportunities, and that would harm everyone in the long run.

Personally, I believe university education should be free at least for talented and hardworking students, but not necessarily for everyone in exactly the same way. I support broad access, but I think governments also need a fair selection system and enough funding to protect quality. That seems the most balanced solution, because it combines opportunity with responsibility and keeps standards high.

MULTILEVEL · SPEAKING

# TEST 6

**Real Exam 2026 · Set A**

Weekends and weather · Driving a car and using public transport · Achieving success · Electric cars

## PART 1.1 — Personal questions

🎙️ **Answer the questions about yourself. Speak for about 30 seconds each.**

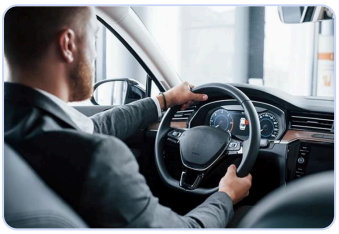
**1** What kind of weather do you dislike?
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

**2** Who do you usually spend your weekends with?
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

**3** How often do you use your phone?
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

## PART 1.2 — Compare two pictures

🖼️ **Look at the two pictures and answer the questions.**





**4** What do you see in these pictures?
⏱ 10 s · 🎙 45 s

**5** What are the advantages of using public transport?
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

**6** Why do many people still prefer to drive their own car?
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

## PART 2 — Long turn

🗣️ **Look at the picture and talk about the topic. You have 1 minute to prepare and 2 minutes to speak.**



**Talk about:**

- Describe something you did in your life that was a success.
- How did this success affect you and the people around you?
- What role do hard work, talent and opportunity play in success?

⏱ 1 min · 🎙 2 min

## PART 3 — Discussion

⚖️ **Give a balanced argument for and against the statement, then give your own opinion. 1 minute to prepare, 2 minutes to speak.**

**"Electric cars should completely replace petrol cars."**

| FOR | AGAINST |
|---|---|
| much cleaner air in crowded cities | very few charging stations outside big cities |
| cheaper to run and to maintain over time | the purchase price is still too high for most families |
| reduces a country's dependence on imported fuel | producing and recycling batteries also harms the environment |

⏱ 1 min · 🎙 2 min

**1 Part 1.1 What kind of weather do you dislike?**

I dislike very hot weather with no wind at all, especially when the sun is strong and the air feels heavy. It makes me tired, sweaty, and a bit irritated, so I can't focus on work or enjoy being outside. I always prefer cooler weather, because I feel much more active and comfortable then, and I can think clearly too.

**2 Part 1.1 Who do you usually spend your weekends with?**

I usually spend my weekends with my family or a couple of close friends. We might visit relatives, go out for coffee, or just stay at home and talk. I like that balance, because after a busy week it helps me relax, and at the same time I stay connected with the people who matter most to me.

**3 Part 1.1 How often do you use your phone?**

I use my phone many times a day, probably more than I should. I need it for messages, studying, maps, and checking news, so it has become part of my routine. At the same time, I try not to waste too much time on it, because I know it can easily become a distraction if I'm not careful.

**4 Part 1.2 What do you see in these pictures?**

In these pictures, I can see two different ways of travelling. In the first one, a man is driving a private car, while in the second one, a woman is stepping onto a bus at a stop. The car looks more personal and comfortable, because the driver is in full control of the journey. The bus seems more practical for shared travel, since it can carry many passengers and is better for the environment.

**5 Part 1.2 What are the advantages of using public transport?**

One advantage of public transport is that it is usually much cheaper than using a car every day. Another big benefit is that it helps reduce traffic and air pollution, especially in crowded cities where roads are always busy. I also think it can be less stressful, because you do not have to worry about parking, fuel prices, or long traffic jams. For many people, that makes daily travel easier and more predictable.

**6 Part 1.2 Why do many people still prefer to drive their own car?**

Many people still prefer to drive their own car because it gives them freedom and privacy. They can leave whenever they want, choose the route, and stop wherever they like. It is also more comfortable, especially if they are travelling with family, carrying shopping, or going somewhere with several stops. In addition, some people simply enjoy driving and feel safer in their own vehicle.

**7 Part 2 Describe something you did in your life that was a success.**

One success I'm really proud of is passing an important English exam after months of preparation. At the time, I was studying at school and also helping my family at home, so finding enough time was not easy. Still, I made a strict plan, studied vocabulary every day, wrote short texts, and practised speaking with a friend whenever I could. When I finally got the result, I felt incredibly relieved and confident, because I had proved to myself that steady effort really works.

This success affected me in a very positive way. I became more disciplined, more organised, and much less afraid of difficult tasks. My parents were happy too, because they saw how much energy I had put into it and how seriously I had taken my goal. Even my friends became more motivated, since they realised that success is possible if you keep going and don't give up too soon. I think hard work is the most important factor, because talent alone is never enough. Talent can give you a good start, but without effort it quickly disappears. Opportunity matters as well, because sometimes the right teacher, the right moment, or the right environment can open the door. In my opinion, success usually comes when these three things support each other, and that is exactly what happened in my case.

**8 Part 3 Electric cars should completely replace petrol cars.**

I think the idea of replacing petrol cars with electric ones is very attractive, but it is not as simple as it sounds. Supporters are right that electric cars can make city air much cleaner, which is especially important in crowded places where pollution is a serious health problem. They are also cheaper to run over time, because electricity is often less expensive than fuel and electric engines usually need less maintenance. On top of that, if a country uses more electric transport, it becomes less dependent on imported oil, which is a real advantage for energy security and national stability.

However, there are still strong arguments against a complete replacement. In many areas, there are too few charging stations, so long journeys can be inconvenient, especially outside big cities. Another problem is price: many families simply cannot afford an electric car yet, even if it saves money later. And we also have to be honest about the environmental cost of batteries, because their production needs a lot of resources and their recycling can also damage the environment.

Personally, I support electric cars, but I do not think petrol cars should disappear immediately. I believe the change should happen gradually, with better infrastructure, lower prices, and cleaner battery technology first. If governments and manufacturers solve those problems, then electric cars can truly become the main choice for the future, but for now a mixed transition seems more realistic and fair for everyone.

MULTILEVEL · SPEAKING

# TEST 7

**Real Exam 2026 · Set A**

Daily habits and music · Camping and staying in a hotel · Disagreeing with someone · Taxes on fast food

## PART 1.1 — Personal questions

🎙️ **Answer the questions about yourself. Speak for about 30 seconds each.**

**1** Do you get up early or late?
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

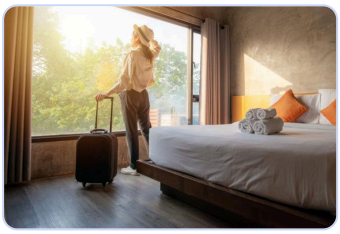
**2** What kind of clothes do you usually wear?
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

**3** Do you listen to music every day?
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

## PART 1.2 — Compare two pictures

🖼️ **Look at the two pictures and answer the questions.**





**4** What do you see in these pictures?
⏱ 10 s · 🎙 45 s

**5** What are the advantages of going camping?
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

**6** Why do some people prefer staying in a hotel?
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

## PART 2 — Long turn

🗣️ **Look at the picture and talk about the topic. You have 1 minute to prepare and 2 minutes to speak.**



**Talk about:**

- Tell me about a time when you disagreed with someone.
- What was the situation and how did you express your disagreement?
- What is the best way to disagree with a person politely?

⏱ 1 min · 🎙 2 min

## PART 3 — Discussion

⚖️ **Give a balanced argument for and against the statement, then give your own opinion. 1 minute to prepare, 2 minutes to speak.**

**"Fast food should be taxed much more heavily."**

| FOR | AGAINST |
|---|---|
| higher prices push people towards healthier choices | hits low-income families hardest of all |
| the money raised can fund healthcare and sport | adults should be free to choose their own diet |
| encourages companies to improve what they sell | may damage small businesses and cost jobs |

⏱ 1 min · 🎙 2 min

## MODEL ANSWERS

C1 model answers

**1 Part 1.1 Do you get up early or late?**

I usually get up quite early, around six or seven in the morning, because I like having enough time to wake up properly and prepare for the day without rushing. Early mornings also help me feel more organised and productive, especially when I have work or classes later on, so I generally prefer that routine.

**2 Part 1.1 What kind of clothes do you usually wear?**

I usually wear simple, comfortable clothes like jeans, T-shirts, and trainers, because I spend most of my day doing ordinary activities and I need clothes that are practical. I do like looking neat, but for me comfort matters more than dressing formally every day, especially when I know I will be busy.

**3 Part 1.1 Do you listen to music every day?**

Yes, I do listen to music every day, usually on my way to school, when I am doing chores, or when I want to relax in the evening. Music helps me concentrate, improves my mood, and makes boring moments feel much better, so it is a normal part of my daily life.

**4 Part 1.2 What do you see in these pictures?**

In the first picture, I can see three people sitting outside in a forest near a tent and a campfire. They seem to be camping together and enjoying a quiet moment in nature. In the second picture, there is a woman standing in a modern hotel room near a large window with a suitcase beside the bed. The first place looks more adventurous and social, while the second looks more comfortable and private, and that difference is very clear.

**5 Part 1.2 What are the advantages of going camping?**

One advantage of going camping is that it lets people spend more time in nature, breathe fresh air, and escape the noise of everyday life. It can also be cheaper than many other holidays, especially for families or students. Another benefit is that camping often brings people closer together, because they have to plan, cook, and solve small problems as a group, which creates good memories.

**6 Part 1.2 Why do some people prefer staying in a hotel?**

Some people prefer staying in a hotel because it is much more comfortable and convenient than camping. They do not need to worry about setting up a tent, carrying a lot of equipment, or dealing with bad weather. Hotels also usually offer a soft bed, a private bathroom, and other services, so the whole trip feels easier, safer, and more relaxing.

**7 Part 2 Tell me about a time when you disagreed with someone.**

I remember disagreeing with my cousin during a family discussion about where we should spend our summer holiday. He wanted us to go to a busy city because he thought there would be more entertainment, more shops, and more things to do every day. I understood his point, but I felt that we were all already tired from work and study, so a quieter place would suit us better. I explained my opinion calmly and tried not to sound aggressive. I said things like, "I see why you prefer the city, but I think we need more rest," and "Maybe we could choose a place with nature and fewer crowds." I listened to his reasons first, then gave my own. In the end, we discussed both options carefully and found a compromise: a small lakeside resort. That trip was actually excellent because we could relax, walk outside, and still enjoy some activities. From that experience, I learned that the best way to disagree politely is to respect the other person, speak calmly, and focus on the issue rather than attacking the person. It also helps to offer an alternative instead of just rejecting the idea, because that keeps the conversation constructive and friendly.

**8 Part 3 Fast food should be taxed much more heavily.**

The statement that fast food should be taxed much more heavily is a serious one, and I can see why people disagree about it. On the one hand, supporters say that higher prices would push many people towards healthier choices. If fast food were less affordable, some customers would think more carefully before buying it and might choose home-cooked meals or fresh food instead. They also argue that the money raised could be used for healthcare, school sports, or campaigns that teach people about nutrition. Another point is that pressure from taxes might encourage fast-food companies to improve what they sell, for example by reducing salt, sugar, and fat.

On the other hand, there are important objections. Critics say this tax would hit low-income families hardest, because cheap fast food is often the easiest option when money is tight. They also believe adults should be free to choose their own diet without the government telling them what to eat. In addition, small businesses might suffer if customers stop buying their products, and that could mean fewer jobs in local communities.

My own view is that fast food can be taxed more, but not so heavily that it becomes unfair. I would prefer a balanced policy: higher taxes on the unhealthiest products, plus cheaper healthy options and clear public information. That way, people are guided rather than punished, and the policy would be both practical and more acceptable.

MULTILEVEL · SPEAKING

# TEST 8

**Real Exam 2026 · Set A**

Routine, food and health · Life in a city and in the countryside · Feeling truly free · Art classes at school

## PART 1.1 — Personal questions

🎙️ **Answer the questions about yourself. Speak for about 30 seconds each.**

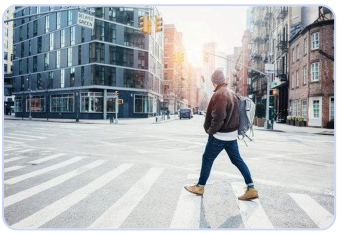
**1** What do you do after work or after school?
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

**2** What is your favourite meal of the day?
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

**3** What do you do to stay healthy?
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

## PART 1.2 — Compare two pictures

🖼️ **Look at the two pictures and answer the questions.**





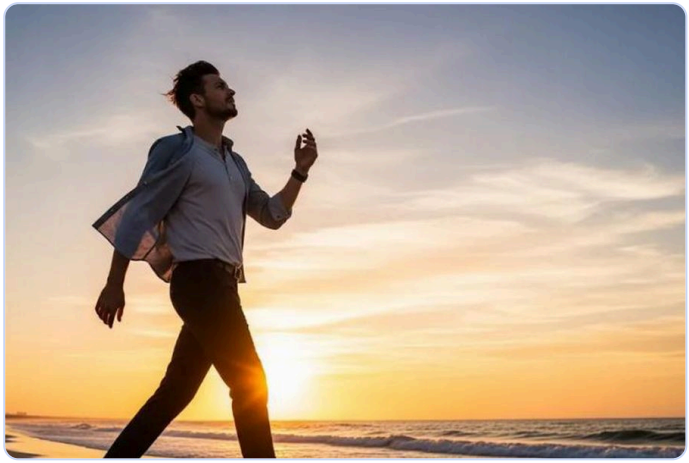
**4** What do you see in these pictures?
⏱ 10 s · 🎙 45 s

**5** Which place would you prefer to live in, and why?
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

**6** What are the advantages of living in each of these places?
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

## PART 2 — Long turn

🗣️ **Look at the picture and talk about the topic. You have 1 minute to prepare and 2 minutes to speak.**



**Talk about:**

- Tell me about a moment when you felt truly free.
- Where were you and what were you doing?
- What stops people from feeling free in everyday life?

⏱ 1 min · 🎙 2 min

## PART 3 — Discussion

⚖️ **Give a balanced argument for and against the statement, then give your own opinion. 1 minute to prepare, 2 minutes to speak.**

**"Art classes should be compulsory in every school."**

| FOR | AGAINST |
|---|---|
| develops creativity and problem-solving | takes lesson time from maths, science and languages |
| gives students a way to express feelings | schools lack materials and trained art teachers |
| improves results in other academic subjects too | students with no interest gain very little from it |

⏱ 1 min · 🎙 2 min

**1 Part 1.1 What do you do after work or after school?**

After work or school, I usually relax for a short time and then do something useful, like going for a walk, helping at home, or reviewing my lessons. I need that little break first, because it helps me switch off mentally and still feel productive in the evening, instead of just wasting the whole night.

**2 Part 1.1 What is your favourite meal of the day?**

My favourite meal of the day is definitely dinner, because it is when the whole family can sit together and eat properly. I also like it because I can have something warm, filling, and comforting after a busy day, and that makes the evening feel complete, calm, and much more enjoyable.

**3 Part 1.1 What do you do to stay healthy?**

To stay healthy, I try to eat reasonably well, drink enough water, and keep active every day. Even simple things like walking more, sleeping at a sensible time, and not overeating make a big difference, so I try to be consistent rather than extreme or unrealistic in my habits.

**4 Part 1.2 What do you see in these pictures?**

In the first picture, I can see a person walking across a wide city street with tall modern buildings around him. In the second picture, there is a road leading through a natural landscape with mountains, trees, and open space. The first place looks busy and urban, while the second feels calm and spacious. I think the city offers more activity and convenience, but the mountain area seems more peaceful and beautiful overall to me.

**5 Part 1.2 Which place would you prefer to live in, and why?**

I would prefer to live in the second place, near the mountains, because it looks much quieter and less stressful for everyday life. I like the idea of fresh air, open views, and being close to nature every day. The city would probably be more practical for work, shopping, and transport, but for my personal comfort, the natural setting would suit me much better.

**6 Part 1.2 What are the advantages of living in each of these places?**

The city has obvious advantages such as better transport, more jobs, and easier access to shops, cafes, and services. In contrast, the mountain area offers cleaner air, less noise, and a more relaxing lifestyle. So each place has something valuable, depending on whether a person prefers convenience and activity, or peace and space in daily life.

**7 Part 2 Tell me about a moment when you felt truly free.**

One moment when I felt truly free was during a trip to the mountains with my friends a few years ago. We had no strict plan, no classes, and no phone calls to answer, so it felt like the whole day belonged to us. We were walking along a quiet path, laughing, taking photos, and stopping whenever we wanted. At one point we reached a high viewpoint, and I remember looking around and feeling completely light, as if all my usual worries had disappeared.

I was in a very open natural place, surrounded by trees, fresh air, and a huge sky above us. I was just walking, talking, and enjoying the moment without thinking about schedules or obligations. That is what made it so special: I could choose what to do next without anyone controlling me, and that sense of independence felt incredibly refreshing and unforgettable.

In everyday life, many things stop people from feeling free. Responsibilities are the biggest one, because school, work, and family duties create pressure. Money problems can also make people feel trapped, since they cannot always make their own choices. On top of that, social expectations and fear of judgment can limit people's behaviour. Sometimes we are physically free, but mentally we still feel restricted by stress and routine.

**8 Part 3 Art classes should be compulsory in every school.**

The idea that art classes should be compulsory in every school is quite controversial, but I can see strong arguments on both sides.

On the one hand, art can be very valuable because it develops creativity and helps students solve problems in different ways. It also gives young people a safe way to express emotions they may find difficult to put into words. In addition, creative subjects often support other areas of learning, because students become more imaginative, focused, and confident, which can improve their performance in academic subjects too.

On the other hand, schools have limited time, and making art compulsory could reduce the number of lessons available for maths, science, and languages. Another practical issue is that many schools simply do not have enough materials or trained teachers to teach art properly. Also, if a student has absolutely no interest in art, forcing them to study it may not bring much benefit and could even lower motivation.

In my opinion, art should be part of every school, but not necessarily as a rigid compulsory subject in the same way as maths or English. I think schools should guarantee access to art, because it is important for personal development, but they should also allow some flexibility so students can engage with it in a way that suits their interests and talents. That approach seems the most balanced and realistic.

MULTILEVEL · SPEAKING

# TEST 9

**Real Exam 2026 · Set A**

Cooking, cinema and museums · Shopping online and in a store · A festival you enjoyed · Limits on personal income

## PART 1.1 — Personal questions

**Answer the questions about yourself. Speak for about 30 seconds each.**

1. **What do you usually cook at home?**
   ⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s
2. **How often do you go to the cinema?**
   ⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s
3. **Are museums popular in your country?**
   ⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

## PART 1.2 — Compare two pictures

**Look at the two pictures and answer the questions.**





4. **What do you see in these pictures?**
   ⏱ 10 s · 🎙 45 s
5. **What are the advantages of shopping online?**
   ⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s
6. **Why do many people still prefer to shop in a real store?**
   ⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

## PART 2 — Long turn

**Look at the picture and talk about the topic. You have 1 minute to prepare and 2 minutes to speak.**



**Talk about:**

- Describe a festival that you really enjoyed.
- Who did you celebrate it with?
- Why are traditional festivals important for a country?

⏱ 1 min · 🎙 2 min

## PART 3 — Discussion

**Give a balanced argument for and against the statement, then give your own opinion. 1 minute to prepare, 2 minutes to speak.**

> **"Governments should limit how much money one person can earn."**

| FOR | AGAINST |
|---|---|
| reduces the gap between the richest and the poorest | removes the motivation to build and to invest |
| more money left for wages and public services | talented people will simply move to other countries |
| limits the political power of very wealthy individuals | success should be rewarded, not punished |

⏱ 1 min · 🎙 2 min

**1 Part 1.1 What do you usually cook at home?**

At home, I usually cook simple dishes like rice, pasta, or soup, because they are quick, affordable, and healthy enough for everyday life. On busy weekdays, I prefer something easy that I can prepare in less than half an hour. At weekends, though, I like trying a more complicated recipe with my family, especially if we can all sit down and eat together.

**2 Part 1.1 How often do you go to the cinema?**

I don't go to the cinema very often, maybe once every few months, because I can watch films at home quite comfortably on my own schedule. Still, I really enjoy the cinema when there is a new movie I have been waiting for, since the big screen, the dark room, and the sound system make everything feel much more exciting.

**3 Part 1.1 Are museums popular in your country?**

Yes, museums are quite popular in my country, especially among students, tourists, and families with children. People like them because they are educational, interesting, and often nicely organized. Many museums also have modern interactive exhibitions, so they are not boring at all, and that makes it easier for young visitors to enjoy history and art.

**4 Part 1.2 What do you see in these pictures?**

In the first picture, I can see a person shopping online on a laptop, holding a bank card, so it looks as if they are buying something from a website. In the second picture, there is a woman in a real clothes shop, looking carefully at garments on a rack. The main difference is that one person is shopping digitally at home, while the other is choosing items physically in a store. One setting feels more private and convenient, and the other feels more immediate and personal.

**5 Part 1.2 What are the advantages of shopping online?**

One big advantage of shopping online is convenience, because you can buy almost anything without leaving your home. It also saves time, especially if you are busy, and you can compare prices very quickly on different websites. In addition, online shops often have a much wider choice than local stores, so it is easier to find exactly what you want, even if it is something unusual or from another country.

**6 Part 1.2 Why do many people still prefer to shop in a real store?**

Many people still prefer real stores because they want to see, touch, and try products before paying for them. That is especially important for clothes, shoes, cosmetics, and even some electronics, because quality matters a lot. Also, shopping in a store can feel more reliable, because you get the item immediately and do not have to wait for delivery, which some people find frustrating.

**7 Part 2 Describe a festival that you really enjoyed.**

One festival I really enjoyed was Navruz, which is one of the most important celebrations in my country. I remember going to a local park with my family when I was younger, and the whole day felt bright and lively from the beginning. The weather was warm, there were colorful decorations everywhere, and many people were wearing traditional clothes. We watched music and dance performances on a small stage, tried different festive dishes, and walked around the fair stalls together. I especially liked the atmosphere because everyone seemed cheerful, relaxed, and proud of the holiday. I celebrated it with my parents, my grandparents, and my cousins, so it felt very warm and personal. My grandmother had cooked sumalak at home, and that memory is still special to me because we stayed up late talking and laughing while it was being prepared. For me, traditional festivals are important because they connect people to their history and help younger generations understand their culture. They also bring families and communities together, which creates a strong sense of unity and belonging. In my opinion, that is one of the best things a country can have.

**8 Part 3 Governments should limit how much money one person can earn.**

I think this is a very serious and controversial idea, because it raises questions about fairness, freedom, and social responsibility. On the one hand, limiting how much one person can earn could make society fairer. It would reduce the distance between the richest and the poorest, and that might create a more stable country with less resentment. It could also leave more money for better wages and public services like education, healthcare, and transport. Another benefit is that very wealthy people would have less political influence, which is a real concern in many countries, because money often leads to power. On the other hand, there are strong arguments against such limits. If people know their income is capped, some of them may lose the motivation to work hard, build businesses, or invest in new projects. In a global economy, talented entrepreneurs, specialists, and investors might simply move abroad, where the rules are more flexible and they can earn more. I also believe success should be rewarded, not punished, because ambition and innovation are important for progress. Personally, I would not support strict income limits. I think governments should tax high incomes more fairly and use that money well, but they should not completely control how much someone can earn.

MULTILEVEL · SPEAKING

# TEST 10

**Real Exam 2026 · Set A**

Animals, music and outdoor life · At the cinema and watching films at home · Noticing inequality · Performance pay in sport

## PART 1.1 — Personal questions

**Answer the questions about yourself. Speak for about 30 seconds each.**

**1** Do you like animals?
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

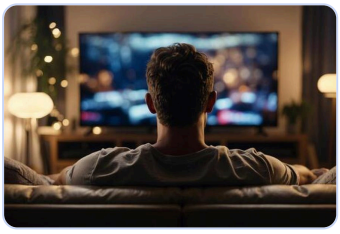
**2** Who is your favourite singer?
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

**3** What outdoor activities do you do?
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

## PART 1.2 — Compare two pictures

**Look at the two pictures and answer the questions.**





**4** What do you see in these pictures?
⏱ 10 s · 🎙 45 s

**5** What are the advantages of watching a film at the cinema?
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

**6** Why do many people prefer watching films at home?
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

## PART 2 — Long turn

**Look at the picture and talk about the topic. You have 1 minute to prepare and 2 minutes to speak.**



**Talk about:**

- Describe a time when you noticed or experienced inequality.
- What did that experience teach you?
- What effect does inequality have on a society?

⏱ 1 min · 🎙 2 min

## PART 3 — Discussion

**Give a balanced argument for and against the statement, then give your own opinion. 1 minute to prepare, 2 minutes to speak.**

**"Sports teams should be allowed to pay players according to their performance."**

| FOR | AGAINST |
|---|---|
| rewards hard work, skill and real results | creates unhealthy competition inside the team |
| motivates every player to give their best | players in defensive roles get fewer chances to shine |
| makes teams more competitive and financially efficient | focuses attention on individuals rather than teamwork |

⏱ 1 min · 🎙 2 min

**1 Part 1.1 Do you like animals?**

Yes, I do. I think animals make life more interesting, and I especially enjoy being around friendly pets like dogs and cats. They can calm people down, and I like the feeling of responsibility that comes with caring for them every day. If I had more space at home, I'd probably keep a dog because I enjoy the companionship they give.

**2 Part 1.1 Who is your favourite singer?**

My favourite singer is Ed Sheeran. I like his voice because it sounds very natural, and his songs are easy to listen to but still meaningful. I often hear his music when I study or travel, and I think he is one of those artists whose songs stay in your head for a long time.

**3 Part 1.1 What outdoor activities do you do?**

In my free time, I usually go for walks, play football with friends, or ride my bike around the neighbourhood. I like outdoor activities because they help me stay healthy, clear my mind, and give me a break from screens and schoolwork. Being outside also makes me feel more energetic and positive, especially after a busy day.

**4 Part 1.2 What do you see in these pictures?**

In the first picture, I see two people sitting in a cinema and watching a film on a big screen. They are smiling and eating popcorn, so they seem to be enjoying themselves a lot. In the second picture, there is one man sitting on a sofa at home and watching television. Both pictures show people relaxing with a film, but the cinema looks more social and exciting, while the home scene feels quieter and more comfortable.

**5 Part 1.2 What are the advantages of watching a film at the cinema?**

One big advantage of watching a film at the cinema is the atmosphere. The screen is huge, the sound is powerful, and you can really focus on the movie without distractions. Also, it feels like a special outing, especially if you go with friends or family. That shared experience often makes the film more memorable and enjoyable, because everyone reacts together to the same scenes.

**6 Part 1.2 Why do many people prefer watching films at home?**

Many people prefer watching films at home because it is cheaper and more convenient. They can pause the film, choose exactly what they want to watch, and feel completely relaxed in their own space. At home, they do not have to worry about other people talking, finding parking, or following strict cinema rules, so the whole experience feels easier and more personal.

**7 Part 2 Describe a time when you noticed or experienced inequality.**

A time when I noticed inequality was at school during a group project. One student in my class had far more materials and support than the others because his family could afford private tutoring and extra equipment. At first, I did not think much about it, but later I saw that he had a clear advantage in confidence and preparation, while some other students worked twice as hard just to keep up. It was a small example, but it made the difference very visible, and it stayed in my mind for a long time. That experience taught me that inequality is not always obvious. It can appear in small, everyday situations, not only in big social problems, and sometimes people accept it without questioning it. I also learned that fairness does not mean everyone gets exactly the same thing; it means everyone should have a real chance to succeed. I think inequality can damage a society in several ways. It creates frustration, weakens trust, and makes people feel left out. Over time, it can divide communities, increase resentment, and stop talented people from reaching their potential. For that reason, I believe society becomes stronger when it tries to reduce unfair differences and give people more equal opportunities.

**8 Part 3 Sports teams should be allowed to pay players according to their performance.**

I partly agree with the idea that sports teams should be allowed to pay players according to their performance. On the positive side, this system rewards hard work, real skill, and actual results, so it feels fair to many people. It can also push every player to improve, because everyone knows that effort may lead to better pay, more recognition, and perhaps a better career. In addition, if contracts are linked to performance, teams may become more efficient and competitive, since they spend money on people who truly deliver on the pitch or court. However, there are also serious drawbacks. If pay depends too much on individual performance, it can create unhealthy competition inside the team, and that can damage trust and harmony. Players may start thinking about their own statistics instead of helping each other in difficult moments. Also, defenders, goalkeepers, and other less visible players may get fewer chances to shine, even though they are essential to success. In my opinion, teams should use a balanced system. They can reward outstanding performance, but they should also value teamwork, consistency, leadership, and roles that are not always obvious. Otherwise, sport becomes too individualistic, and the whole team suffers in the long run, especially in bigger competitions.

MULTILEVEL · SPEAKING

# TEST 11

**Real Exam 2026 · Set B**

Home, friends and hobbies · Reading a book and watching television · A family tradition · Having a hobby

## PART 1.1 — Personal questions

🎙️ **Answer the questions about yourself. Speak for about 30 seconds each.**

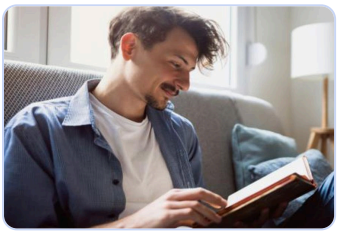
**1** What do you enjoy most about your home?
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

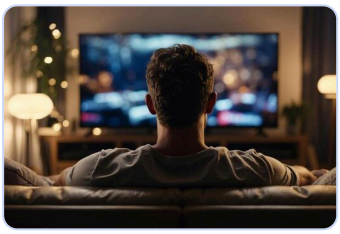
**2** Describe your best friend.
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

**3** What is your favourite hobby?
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

## PART 1.2 — Compare two pictures

🖼️ **Look at the two pictures and answer the questions.**





**4** What do you see in these pictures?
⏱ 10 s · 🎙 45 s

**5** What are the advantages of reading a book in your free time?
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

**6** Why do most people prefer watching television in the evening?
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

## PART 2 — Long turn

🗣️ **Look at the picture and talk about the topic. You have 1 minute to prepare and 2 minutes to speak.**



**Talk about:**

- Describe a tradition that is important in your family or in your region.
- How is this tradition usually celebrated?
- Why is it important for young people to keep old traditions alive?

⏱ 1 min · 🎙 2 min

## PART 3 — Discussion

⚖️ **Give a balanced argument for and against the statement, then give your own opinion. 1 minute to prepare, 2 minutes to speak.**

**"Everyone should have a hobby."**

| FOR | AGAINST |
|---|---|
| a healthy way to relieve stress after work or study | not everyone has the free time or the money for one |
| builds new skills and often new friendships | some hobbies are expensive or even risky |
| encourages creativity and personal growth | a hobby can become an obsession and take over normal life |

⏱ 1 min · 🎙 2 min

**1 Part 1.1 What do you enjoy most about your home?**

What I enjoy most about my home is the sense of peace it gives me. After a busy day, I can relax there, be myself, and spend time with my family without any pressure. For me, that comfort matters more than anything else, because home should feel safe, familiar, and welcoming every single day.

**2 Part 1.1 Describe your best friend.**

My best friend is someone I can completely trust and depend on in difficult moments. He is honest, supportive, and easy to talk to, so I never feel judged around him. We have known each other for years, and that shared history has made our friendship very strong and stable over time.

**3 Part 1.1 What is your favourite hobby?**

My favourite hobby is reading, because it helps me escape from routine and learn something new at the same time. I especially enjoy books that make me think and stay in my mind after I finish them, and I often recommend them to my friends when I find a really good one.

**4 Part 1.2 What do you see in these pictures?**

In the first picture, a young man is sitting on a sofa and reading a book in a bright room with a lamp beside him. In the second picture, another man is sitting at home and watching television in a darker living room. Both people are spending their free time indoors, but the first activity looks quieter and more active for the mind, while the second one seems more passive and relaxing.

**5 Part 1.2 What are the advantages of reading a book in your free time?**

One advantage of reading a book in my free time is that it improves my vocabulary and concentration. It also gives me a break from screens, which I think is healthy, especially after studying or working all day. Another benefit is that books can stay with you longer, because they often make a deeper impression than short videos or online posts.

**6 Part 1.2 Why do most people prefer watching television in the evening?**

Most people prefer watching television in the evening because it is easy and requires very little effort after a long day. They can sit down, switch it on, and relax without concentrating too much. It is also a simple way to keep up with the news, entertainment, or family programmes while resting at home.

**7 Part 2 Describe a tradition that is important in your family or in your region.**

One tradition that is very important in my family and in my region is celebrating Navruz. It marks the arrival of spring and, for us, it feels like a fresh start after winter. I have always associated it with warmth, kindness, and being together. Even as a child, I understood that this holiday was more than just a day off; it was a meaningful part of our identity and our family life.

Usually, we celebrate it by cleaning the house before the holiday, visiting relatives, and preparing special foods like sumalak and other traditional dishes. In our neighbourhood, there are also concerts, folk games, and people wearing national clothes. Streets become much livelier than usual, and everyone seems to be in a cheerful mood. I remember one Navruz when my family spent the whole day visiting my grandparents, and the atmosphere was so lively that even the children felt part of something meaningful. We laughed, shared food, and talked for hours.

I think it is important for young people to keep old traditions alive because traditions connect us to our history and teach us who we are. They also bring families and communities closer. If young people understand traditions, they can respect their roots while still moving forward in life. Without them, people may lose an important sense of belonging and continuity.

**8 Part 3 Everyone should have a hobby.**

I partly agree that everyone should have a hobby, because hobbies can make life healthier and more balanced. On the one hand, they are a very good way to relieve stress after work or study. When people do something they enjoy, they can switch off from pressure and feel refreshed. Hobbies also help us develop new skills, and quite often they lead to new friendships. For example, if someone joins a sports club or a language group, they may meet people with similar interests. Another strong point is that hobbies encourage creativity and personal growth, which is important at any age and can make everyday life more satisfying and interesting.

On the other hand, I understand that not everyone has the free time or the money for a hobby. Some activities are expensive, such as photography, travelling, or certain sports, and that can stop people from starting them. Others can even be risky if people do them without proper training or equipment. There is also another danger: a hobby can become an obsession and start controlling a person's life instead of improving it, especially if someone begins to ignore work, study, or family responsibilities.

In my opinion, having a hobby is highly desirable, but it should be realistic and balanced. Even a simple hobby, like walking, drawing, or reading, can make a big difference if it fits a person's life and does not create extra problems.

MULTILEVEL · SPEAKING

# TEST 12

**Real Exam 2026 · Set B**

Music, books and evenings · Paper books and electronic books · Time passing quickly or slowly · Standardised testing

## PART 1.1 — Personal questions

🎙️ **Answer the questions about yourself. Speak for about 30 seconds each.**

**1** What kind of music do you enjoy listening to?
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

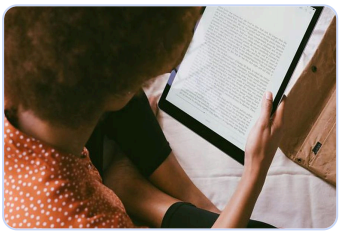
**2** Do you have many books at home?
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

**3** What do you usually do to relax at home?
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

## PART 1.2 — Compare two pictures

🖼️ **Look at the two pictures and answer the questions.**





**4** What do you see in these pictures?
⏱ 10 s · 🎙 45 s

**5** What are the advantages of reading a printed book?
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

**6** Why have electronic books become so popular in recent years?
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

## PART 2 — Long turn

🗣️ **Look at the picture and talk about the topic. You have 1 minute to prepare and 2 minutes to speak.**



**Talk about:**

- Describe a time when the hours passed very quickly, or very slowly.
- What were you doing and how did you feel?
- How important is good time management for a person's success?

⏱ 1 min · 🎙 2 min

## PART 3 — Discussion

⚖️ **Give a balanced argument for and against the statement, then give your own opinion. 1 minute to prepare, 2 minutes to speak.**

**"Standardised tests should be removed from schools."**

| FOR | AGAINST |
|---|---|
| one exam cannot measure a student's real ability | gives a fair and equal measure for every student |
| teachers end up teaching only what will be tested | universities and employers need a comparable result |
| creates serious stress and anxiety among young people | shows which schools and regions need more support |

⏱ 1 min · 🎙 2 min

**1 Part 1.1 What kind of music do you enjoy listening to?**

I enjoy listening to calm pop and sometimes instrumental music because it helps me focus, relax, and even improve my mood after a tiring day. If I am studying or walking somewhere, music makes the time pass more pleasantly, so I listen to it quite often. For me, it is one of the easiest ways to switch off mentally.

**2 Part 1.1 Do you have many books at home?**

Yes, I do. We have quite a lot of books at home, especially school textbooks, novels, and a few old books from my parents and grandparents. I like seeing them on the shelf because they make our home feel more thoughtful, organised, and warm. Even if I do not read every book often, I still value having them around.

**3 Part 1.1 What do you usually do to relax at home?**

Usually I relax at home by listening to music, watching short videos, or having a cup of tea and talking with my family. If I want something quieter, I read a light book or just lie down and rest for a while. These simple things help me recover after a busy day and feel ready for the next one.

**4 Part 1.2 What do you see in these pictures?**

In the first picture, a young boy is sitting in a library and reading a printed book very carefully. There are bookshelves full of books behind him, so the place looks quiet and academic. In the second picture, a person is reading an electronic book on a tablet at home or in a comfortable indoor space. Both pictures show people concentrating on reading, but the first one feels more traditional and peaceful, while the second one looks more modern and convenient for everyday use.

**5 Part 1.2 What are the advantages of reading a printed book?**

One advantage of a printed book is that it is easier on the eyes, especially if you read for a long time. I also like the feeling of turning pages and making notes in the margins, because it makes reading more personal. For me, a real book can create a stronger connection with the story and help me remember it better, so I still prefer paper in many situations.

**6 Part 1.2 Why have electronic books become so popular in recent years?**

Electronic books have become so popular because they are practical, modern, and very easy to carry around. People can store hundreds of books on one small device and read them anywhere, whether they are travelling, waiting, or relaxing at home. They are also often cheaper than printed books, and that makes them especially attractive for students and busy readers who want quick access.

**7 Part 2 Describe a time when the hours passed very quickly, or very slowly.**

There was a time when the hours passed very slowly for me, and that was during an important exam at school. I had prepared for it for weeks, but once I sat down in the classroom, every minute felt much longer than usual. I kept looking at the clock, and it seemed like the hands were barely moving at all. I was doing my best to stay calm, read each question carefully, and manage my time sensibly so I would not panic.

At first, I felt very nervous because I was afraid of making mistakes and disappointing myself. But after a few minutes, I forced myself to concentrate fully on the task, and that helped me feel a little more confident. I remember telling myself to stop thinking about the time and focus only on the next question. That experience taught me that our feeling of time can change depending on the situation.

On the other hand, I also remember a day when time passed very quickly. It was when I was with my friends at a small picnic outside the city. We were talking, playing games, eating together, and taking photos, and suddenly it was evening. That experience showed me that time management is extremely important for success, because if a person plans their day well, they can study better, avoid stress, and still have time for rest. In my opinion, good time management is not only about being busy; it is about using time wisely and staying focused on what really matters every day.

**8 Part 3 Standardised tests should be removed from schools.**

Standardised tests should be removed from schools is a very controversial idea, and I can understand why people argue about it. In my view, there are strong reasons both for and against keeping them.

On the one hand, critics are right to say that one exam cannot show a student's full ability. Some students are strong in class discussions, creative tasks, or practical work, but they may perform badly when they are under pressure in a test hall. Another problem is that teachers sometimes start teaching only what will appear on the exam, so education becomes too narrow and repetitive. In addition, these tests can create serious stress and anxiety, especially for teenagers who already worry a lot about grades, expectations, and their future.

On the other hand, standardised tests do have clear benefits. They give every student the same conditions, so the result is fair and easier to compare across different schools. Universities and employers also need some kind of common measure when they select people from different places and backgrounds. Besides that, test results can show which schools or regions are falling behind and need more support from the education system.

Personally, I think standardised tests should not be completely removed, but they should be used more carefully and in balance with other forms of assessment. They are useful as one part of education, but they should never be the only thing that decides a student's future. In a good system, exams would support learning, not control it completely.

MULTILEVEL · SPEAKING

# TEST 13

**Real Exam 2026 · Set B**

Room, music and television · Phone photographs and camera photographs · Something that did not meet your expectations ·

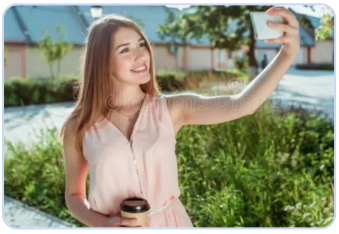
## PART 1.1 — Personal questions

**Answer the questions about yourself. Speak for about 30 seconds each.**

1. **How is your room decorated?**
   ⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s
2. **What is your favourite song?**
   ⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s
3. **Do you watch much television?**
   ⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

## PART 1.2 — Compare two pictures

**Look at the two pictures and answer the questions.**

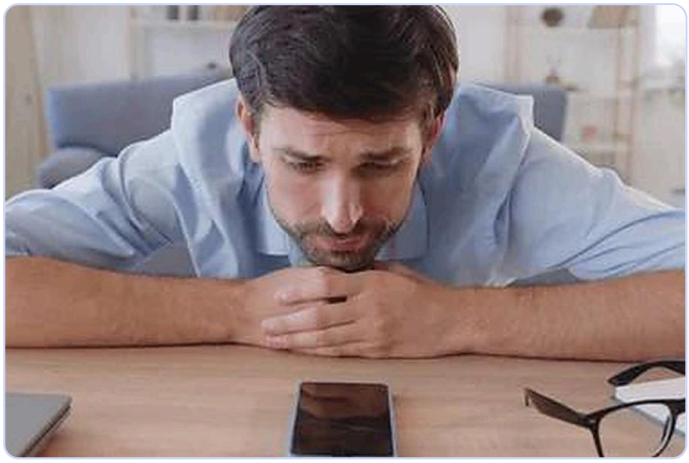




4. **What do you see in these pictures?**
   ⏱ 10 s · 🎙 45 s
5. **Why do so many people prefer taking photographs with a phone?**
   ⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s
6. **What can a professional camera do that a phone cannot?**
   ⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

## PART 2 — Long turn

**Look at the picture and talk about the topic. You have 1 minute to prepare and 2 minutes to speak.**



**Talk about:**

- **Describe a time when something did not meet your expectations.**
- **What had you expected, and what actually happened?**
- **Is it better to have high expectations or low ones?**

⏱ 1 min · 🎙 2 min

## PART 3 — Discussion

**Give a balanced argument for and against the statement, then give your own opinion. 1 minute to prepare, 2 minutes to speak.**

> **"Professional athletes are paid far too much money."**

| FOR | AGAINST |
|---|---|
| their salaries are out of proportion to teachers and doctors | their careers are short and can end with one injury |
| the money could fund grassroots sport for ordinary children | they generate enormous income through tickets and sponsors |
| huge pay gives young fans the wrong idea about success | very few people in the world reach that level of talent |

⏱ 1 min · 🎙 2 min

**1 Part 1.1 How is your room decorated?**

My room is fairly simple but comfortable, and I like it that way. I have a desk, a bed, some shelves, and a few family photos on the wall. There is nothing too flashy or crowded in it, because I prefer a calm, uncluttered space where I can relax, study, and feel at home every single day.

**2 Part 1.1 What is your favourite song?**

My favourite song changes from time to time, but at the moment it is a calm pop song I can listen to while studying or travelling. I like songs with a strong melody and meaningful lyrics because they stay in my head and also improve my mood. Music like that helps me concentrate and feel more positive.

**3 Part 1.1 Do you watch much television?**

Yes, I do watch television, but not very much, and mostly with a purpose. I usually watch it when there is a news report, an interesting documentary, or a film with my family in the evening. I prefer short, useful programmes rather than spending hours on random shows that do not really interest me much.

**4 Part 1.2 What do you see in these pictures?**

In the first picture, a young woman is outside taking a selfie with her phone, and she is holding a takeaway drink in the other hand. She seems to be smiling and enjoying herself in a relaxed outdoor setting. In the second picture, a man is sitting indoors while a photographer is taking his portrait with professional equipment. The first scene looks casual, but the second one feels more formal and carefully prepared.

**5 Part 1.2 Why do so many people prefer taking photographs with a phone?**

I think many people prefer phones because they always have them with them, so taking a photo is quick, simple, and convenient. Also, phone cameras are easy to use, and the pictures can be shared immediately on social media or in messages. For everyday moments, that speed matters more than perfect quality, especially when people want to capture something instantly.

**6 Part 1.2 What can a professional camera do that a phone cannot?**

A professional camera can usually produce much sharper images and gives the photographer far more control over focus, light, and zoom. It is also better in difficult conditions, such as night photography or a studio setting, where detail really matters. A phone is very handy for daily use, but it cannot fully match that level of quality and flexibility.

**7 Part 2 Describe a time when something did not meet your expectations.**

A clear example comes from a family trip I took to a mountain resort. Before we went, I expected fresh air, beautiful views, and a quiet place where we could rest properly. I imagined long walks, tasty local food, and a comfortable hotel, so I was really looking forward to it for weeks. In reality, the scenery was beautiful, but the hotel was much smaller and noisier than I had expected, and the weather changed very quickly. It rained heavily on the first day, so some of our plans had to be cancelled. At first I felt disappointed, because I had built the trip up in my mind. However, after a while I realised that the unexpected parts made the experience more memorable. We ended up spending more time together indoors, playing cards, drinking tea, and talking late into the evening. For me, this showed that expectations can shape our feelings a lot. I think it is better to have realistic expectations rather than extremely high or extremely low ones. High expectations can motivate us, but if they are too high, we become disappointed very easily. Low expectations protect us from frustration, but they can also stop us from enjoying life fully. Personally, I try to hope for the best while staying practical and flexible, especially when the situation is outside my control.

**8 Part 3 Professional athletes are paid far too much money.**

The statement is that professional athletes are paid far too much money. I can see why many people think that, and there are strong arguments on both sides. On the one hand, their salaries often seem completely out of proportion when we compare them with the pay of teachers or doctors, who do essential work every single day. People also argue that some of that money could be used to develop grassroots sport for ordinary children, which would benefit society much more in the long run. Another important point is that huge salaries can send the wrong message to young fans, making success look like fame and money rather than hard work, discipline, and character. On the other hand, professional sport is a huge business. Top athletes help bring in enormous income through ticket sales, television rights, sponsorships, and merchandise, so in a sense they earn what the market is willing to pay. Also, their careers are very short, and one serious injury can end everything overnight. Finally, very few people ever reach that level, so the payment reflects how exceptional their talent really is. In my opinion, the salaries are sometimes excessive, but I would not say they are completely unjustified. What bothers me most is not that athletes earn a lot, but that society often fails to value other important professions enough. I think the real issue is balance, not envy or punishment, and that is why I would support a fairer distribution of rewards overall.

MULTILEVEL · SPEAKING

# TEST 14

**Real Exam 2026 · Set B**

Neighbourhood, friends and the internet · Travelling by bus and by bicycle · Working as part of a team · Tourism in historical

## PART 1.1 — Personal questions

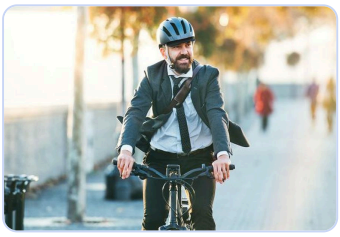
**Answer the questions about yourself. Speak for about 30 seconds each.**

1. **Tell me about your neighbourhood.**
   ⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s
2. **How do you usually travel around your city?**
   ⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s
3. **Do you prefer spending time alone or with other people?**
   ⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

## PART 1.2 — Compare two pictures

**Look at the two pictures and answer the questions.**





4. **What do you see in these pictures?**
   ⏱ 10 s · 🎙 45 s
5. **What are the benefits of cycling to work or to school?**
   ⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s
6. **Why do most people in your country use public transport instead?**
   ⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

## PART 2 — Long turn

**Look at the picture and talk about the topic. You have 1 minute to prepare and 2 minutes to speak.**



**Talk about:**

- **Describe a time when you worked as part of a team.**
- **What was your own role in that team?**
- **What are the benefits of working together to reach a goal?**

⏱ 1 min · 🎙 2 min

## PART 3 — Discussion

**Give a balanced argument for and against the statement, then give your own opinion. 1 minute to prepare, 2 minutes to speak.**

**"The number of tourists allowed into historical cities should be limited."**

| FOR | AGAINST |
|---|---|
| protects fragile monuments from damage and overcrowding | tourism is a major source of income and local jobs |
| improves daily life for the people who live there | everyone has the right to see their own cultural heritage |
| a calmer visit is a better experience for the tourist too | the money from visitors pays for restoration work |

⏱ 1 min · 🎙 2 min

**1 Part 1.1 Tell me about your neighbourhood.**

My neighbourhood is fairly quiet and friendly, and I really like living there. There are a few small shops, a park, and a school nearby, so most of the things I need are within easy reach. I also feel comfortable there because people know each other a little, and that creates a sense of safety and community.

**2 Part 1.1 How do you usually travel around your city?**

I usually travel around my city by bus or, if the distance is short, on foot. Public transport is practical because it is cheap, regular, and I do not have to worry about parking or traffic. Walking is even better in the centre, where the streets are crowded and I can get places quite quickly.

**3 Part 1.1 Do you prefer spending time alone or with other people?**

I usually enjoy spending time with other people more, because I like talking, sharing ideas, and feeling part of a group. I get energy from social contact, and it helps me relax after a busy day. Still, I also need some time alone sometimes, because too much socialising can be tiring for anyone, even if I am the one who suggested going out in the first place.

**4 Part 1.2 What do you see in these pictures?**

In the first picture, a woman is getting on a yellow city bus, probably at a bus stop in a built-up area. In the second picture, a man in a suit and helmet is riding a bicycle outdoors, and he seems to be on his way to work. Both pictures show everyday transport, but one person is using public transport while the other is cycling. The bus looks more suitable for longer or busier routes, while the bicycle suggests more freedom and exercise.

**5 Part 1.2 What are the benefits of cycling to work or to school?**

Cycling to work or school has a lot of benefits. It is healthy because it gives you daily exercise, and it is also cheaper than driving a car or taking a taxi. On top of that, it produces no direct pollution, so it is better for the environment. For me, one of the biggest advantages is that cycling can save time in crowded cities, especially if there are traffic jams.

**6 Part 1.2 Why do most people in your country use public transport instead?**

In my country, many people still use public transport because it is usually the most affordable option. Buses and minibuses reach many neighbourhoods, so people do not need a car for every journey. Also, not everyone feels safe or comfortable cycling in busy traffic, especially children and older people. In addition, the weather can be very hot in summer or cold in winter, which makes public transport more practical overall.

**7 Part 2 Describe a time when you worked as part of a team.**

One time when I worked as part of a team was during a school project in my final year. We had to prepare a presentation about how to improve life in our city, and the teacher asked us to work in groups of four. At first, we were a bit disorganised because everyone had ideas, but no clear plan. Then we divided the work and started helping each other properly.

My own role in the team was to organise the material and make sure our presentation had a clear structure. I also researched some statistics and helped turn our notes into simple, natural English. Another student designed the slides, and the other two practised speaking parts. I think my strength was keeping everything on track and checking that we finished on time. I remember one evening we stayed after class to correct mistakes together, and that made the whole project much stronger.

The biggest benefit of working together is that you can combine different skills and finish a task more effectively. One person may be creative, another may be good at speaking, and another may be strong with details. Also, when people support each other, the pressure feels smaller. In my experience, a team can produce a much better result than one person working alone, especially when there is a lot to do.

**8 Part 3 The number of tourists allowed into historical cities should be limited.**

I think the idea of limiting the number of tourists in historical cities is understandable, but it should not be done too strictly. On the one hand, I agree that these places need protection. Old monuments are fragile, and too many visitors can damage streets, buildings, and the overall atmosphere. Crowds also make daily life harder for local residents, and the city becomes less enjoyable for everyone. In fact, a calmer visit often gives tourists a better experience because they can actually appreciate the place instead of rushing through it.

On the other hand, tourism brings real benefits. In many historical cities, it is a major source of income and creates jobs for guides, hotel workers, shop owners, and restaurant staff. I also think people should have the chance to see and enjoy cultural heritage, not just locals. What is more, the money tourists spend can be used to restore monuments and maintain public spaces, which is extremely important for preservation. Without that income, many beautiful places would struggle to survive.

So, my opinion is that cities should control numbers in a smart way rather than simply closing themselves off. For example, they can use timed tickets, protect the busiest sites, and encourage visitors to come in less crowded seasons. That seems to me like the best balance between preservation and access, and it respects both the city and the people who want to visit it. In other words, the goal should be sustainable tourism, not a total ban.

MULTILEVEL · SPEAKING

# TEST 15

**Real Exam 2026 · Set B**

Family, breakfast and travel · Living in a flat and living in a house · Doing something on your own · Space tourism

## PART 1.1 — Personal questions

**Answer the questions about yourself. Speak for about 30 seconds each.**

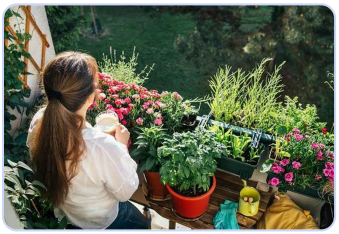
**1** **Describe your family.**
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

**2** **Tell me about the nicest place you have ever visited.**
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

**3** **What do you usually do with your family at the weekend?**
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

## PART 1.2 — Compare two pictures

**Look at the two pictures and answer the questions.**





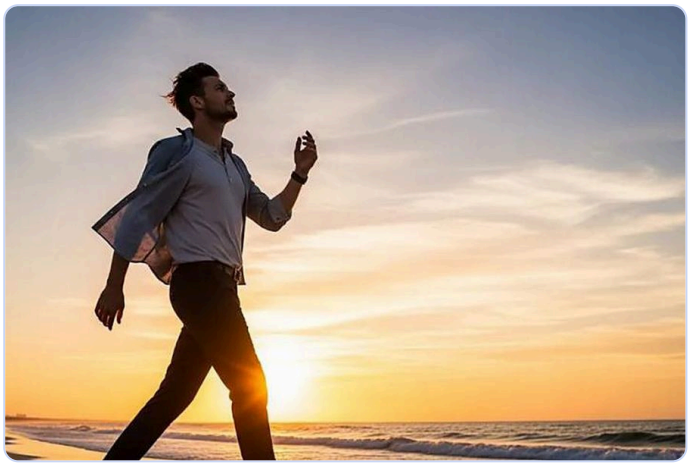
**4** **What do you see in these pictures?**
⏱ 10 s · 🎙 45 s

**5** **What are the advantages of living in a house with a garden?**
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

**6** **Why do so many people choose to live in a flat in the city?**
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

## PART 2 — Long turn

**Look at the picture and talk about the topic. You have 1 minute to prepare and 2 minutes to speak.**



**Talk about:**

- **Describe a time when you did something important completely on your own.**
- **How did you feel while you were doing it?**
- **At what age should young people start becoming independent?**

⏱ 1 min · 🎙 2 min

## PART 3 — Discussion

**Give a balanced argument for and against the statement, then give your own opinion. 1 minute to prepare, 2 minutes to speak.**

**"Space tourism should be banned."**

| FOR | AGAINST |
|---|---|
| every flight releases an enormous amount of pollution | private spending speeds up space technology for everyone |
| the money would do more good solving problems on Earth | it creates highly skilled jobs and whole new industries |
| it is a luxury only the very richest people can buy | exploration has always pushed human knowledge forward |

⏱ 1 min · 🎙 2 min

**1 Part 1.1 Describe your family.**

I'd say my family is quite close-knit and supportive. There are four of us: my parents, my younger sister and me. We don't always agree on everything, but we usually solve problems by talking calmly and listening to each other, and that makes home feel safe, relaxed, and comfortable for everyone.

**2 Part 1.1 Tell me about the nicest place you have ever visited.**

The nicest place I've ever visited was probably a quiet mountain area with fresh air, green views, and a very peaceful atmosphere. I liked it because it was completely different from my usual routine, so I could switch off, enjoy the scenery, take a lot of photos, and really relax for a while.

**3 Part 1.1 What do you usually do with your family at the weekend?**

At the weekend, I usually spend time with my family at home or go out together for a meal or a short walk. I think these simple moments matter most, because they help us stay connected, share small news, laugh together, and enjoy each other's company even when weekdays are busy.

**4 Part 1.2 What do you see in these pictures?**

In the first picture, I can see a woman sitting on a balcony surrounded by many potted plants and flowers, and she seems to be enjoying a drink while looking out over the garden below. In the second picture, there is a family sitting together at a dining table in a kitchen, eating a meal and smiling. Both pictures show calm, homely moments, but the first one feels more private and quiet, while the second one is warmer, busier, and more social.

**5 Part 1.2 What are the advantages of living in a house with a garden?**

One advantage of living in a house with a garden is that you have more space and fresh air around you. You can relax outside, grow plants, have a barbecue, or let children play safely. I think a garden also makes a home feel more peaceful and pleasant, especially if you spend a lot of time indoors during the week.

**6 Part 1.2 Why do so many people choose to live in a flat in the city?**

Many people choose to live in a flat in the city because it is practical and convenient for everyday life. Flats are often closer to work, schools, shops, cafés, and public transport, so people can save time and money. For busy people, that convenience often matters more than having a large amount of space, a quiet garden, or extra rooms.

**7 Part 2 Describe a time when you did something important completely on your own.**

A few years ago, I organised a small charity event at my school completely on my own. We wanted to raise money for children who needed books, so I decided to plan everything myself instead of waiting for other people. I made posters, spoke to teachers, collected donations, and arranged a small table where students could buy cakes and drinks. It was the first time I had taken responsibility for such a big task without asking someone else to do it for me.

While I was doing it, I felt nervous at first because I was afraid something might go wrong. I worried that nobody would support the idea or that I would forget something important. However, as more people became interested and started helping, I became much more confident and proud of myself. By the end of the day, I felt tired but very satisfied, because I could clearly see that my effort had made a real difference.

That experience taught me that I can manage difficult things if I stay organised, calm, and focused. In my opinion, young people should start becoming independent quite early, but in small steps rather than all at once. Around 14 or 15 is a good age to begin taking more responsibility, such as managing money, helping at home, or solving simple problems alone. If teenagers learn independence gradually, they are much more likely to become confident adults later on.

**8 Part 3 Space tourism should be banned.**

I think this is a difficult issue, because space tourism has both serious disadvantages and some possible benefits. On the one hand, I understand why people want it banned. Every flight creates a huge amount of pollution, and that is hard to justify when we already have so many environmental problems on Earth. Also, the money spent on luxury trips into space could be used to fight poverty, improve education, build hospitals, or support scientific research that helps ordinary people directly. And honestly, at the moment, this is mostly entertainment for the very richest people, not something ordinary citizens can enjoy.

On the other hand, I don't think a complete ban is the best solution. Private investment often pushes technology forward much faster than governments can do alone, because companies compete to make things safer, cheaper, and more efficient. What starts as an expensive luxury can later become useful for everyone, just like many modern technologies did in the past. It also creates highly skilled jobs and supports new industries in engineering, science, manufacturing, and tourism. More importantly, exploration has always helped humanity learn more about the universe and about our own planet.

My own view is that space tourism should not be banned, but it should be tightly controlled and limited. Companies should be required to reduce emissions as much as possible, and part of their profits could support environmental or scientific projects on Earth. In that way, we can protect the planet without stopping progress completely.

MULTILEVEL · SPEAKING

# TEST 16

**Real Exam 2026 · Set B**

Home, pets and food · Talking on the phone and talking face to face · Advice you were given · Video games

## PART 1.1 — Personal questions

🎙️ **Answer the questions about yourself. Speak for about 30 seconds each.**

**1** **Describe your home.**
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

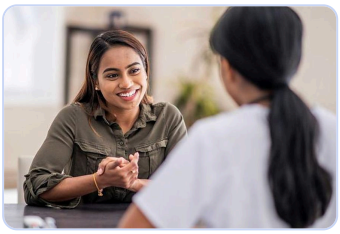
**2** **Do you have any pets?**
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

**3** **What is your favourite meal of the day?**
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

## PART 1.2 — Compare two pictures

🖼️ **Look at the two pictures and answer the questions.**





**4** **What do you see in these pictures?**
⏱ 10 s · 🎙 45 s

**5** **What are the advantages of talking to someone face to face?**
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

**6** **Why do people often prefer to call or message instead?**
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

## PART 2 — Long turn

🗣️ **Look at the picture and talk about the topic. You have 1 minute to prepare and 2 minutes to speak.**



**Talk about:**

- **Describe a time when someone gave you useful advice.**
- **Who gave you that advice, and did you follow it?**
- **Why do some people find it difficult to accept advice?**

⏱ 1 min · 🎙 2 min

## PART 3 — Discussion

⚖️ **Give a balanced argument for and against the statement, then give your own opinion. 1 minute to prepare, 2 minutes to speak.**

**"Video games are beneficial for young people."**

| FOR | AGAINST |
|---|---|
| improve reaction speed, memory and problem-solving | long hours of screen time harm health and sleep |
| many games are played in teams and build cooperation | take time away from study, sport and real friendships |
| a cheap and social way for young people to relax | some games are violent or designed to be addictive |

⏱ 1 min · 🎙 2 min

**1 Part 1.1 Describe your home.**

My home is a fairly comfortable apartment in a quiet part of the city. It isn't very large, but it feels warm and welcoming because my family has made it our own with books, plants, simple furniture, and a lot of personal touches. I like it because it is peaceful and easy to relax in after a busy day.

**2 Part 1.1 Do you have any pets?**

Yes, I do have pets. I have a cat, and I really enjoy looking after him because he is calm, funny, and easy to be around, especially when I'm tired after a long day. He also gives the house a more lively feeling, and I think pets make daily life less stressful and more enjoyable.

**3 Part 1.1 What is your favourite meal of the day?**

My favourite meal of the day is dinner, because that is when my family usually sits together and talks about our day. I also like it because I can eat slowly and relax after school or work, instead of rushing. For me, dinner feels like both a meal and a chance to connect with people.

**4 Part 1.2 What do you see in these pictures?**

In the first picture, I can see a man in a suit talking on a mobile phone, probably in a public place like a station or airport, because there is a busy board in the background. In the second picture, two women are sitting face to face and having a friendly conversation indoors. The main difference is that the first person is communicating by phone, while the second scene shows direct personal contact and a much warmer, more personal kind of communication.

**5 Part 1.2 What are the advantages of talking to someone face to face?**

One clear advantage of talking face to face is that I can understand the other person much better. I can see their facial expressions, gestures, and tone of voice, so the conversation feels warmer and more natural. It also helps avoid misunderstandings, because if something is unclear, I can react immediately, ask another question, and explain myself properly. That makes the whole exchange easier and often more honest.

**6 Part 1.2 Why do people often prefer to call or message instead?**

People often prefer to call or message instead because it is faster and more convenient in daily life. They may be busy, travelling, or simply unable to meet in person. Also, messages give people time to think before answering, which can be useful if the topic is serious or emotional, and it sometimes feels easier to write than to speak directly, especially when people are shy.

**7 Part 2 Describe a time when someone gave you useful advice.**

Once, I was struggling to organise my study time before an important exam, and a teacher gave me very useful advice. She told me to stop trying to revise everything at once and instead make a simple daily plan with short sessions and regular breaks. That sounded basic, but it changed my routine completely. Before that, I used to study for hours without a clear order, and I often ended up feeling tired and confused.

I followed her advice, and within a week I felt much calmer and more in control. I wrote a timetable, divided the subjects into smaller parts, and checked off each task when I finished it. In the end, I studied more efficiently and did better in the exam than I expected.

The advice came from my literature teacher, who knew that I often worked under pressure and then became exhausted. I trusted her because she was experienced and had seen many students make the same mistake. I also respected her because she never spoke to me in a harsh way; she explained things clearly and kindly, which made it easier to accept what she said.

I think some people find it difficult to accept advice because they feel it is a criticism of their abilities. Others are too proud to admit they need help, even when the advice is clearly sensible. Sometimes people also want to make their own mistakes first, because they believe that only personal experience can teach them something properly. In some cases, advice is hard to hear simply because it challenges a habit they have had for years.

**8 Part 3 Video games are beneficial for young people.**

I think the statement that video games are beneficial for young people is partly true, but it depends very much on how they are used. On the one hand, many games can improve reaction speed, memory, and problem-solving skills, because players have to think quickly and make decisions under pressure. In strategy or adventure games, for example, you often have to remember rules, plan several moves ahead, and adapt when something goes wrong. Also, a lot of games are team-based, so they can teach cooperation, communication, and even leadership. If friends play together online, they also have a shared activity and a reason to stay in touch. Another point is that gaming can be a cheap and social way to relax, especially for teenagers who cannot always afford other hobbies or entertainment.

On the other hand, there are serious drawbacks. Long hours in front of a screen can damage health and sleep, especially if young people play late at night and then wake up tired the next morning. Games can also take time away from study, exercise, and real friendships, which are all important for healthy development. In addition, some games are violent, and some are clearly designed to be addictive, so players may find it hard to stop even when they know they should.

Overall, I would say video games are beneficial only when they are balanced and limited. Used sensibly, they can be entertaining and even educational, but they should never replace real life activities or the responsibilities that young people need to develop.

MULTILEVEL · SPEAKING

# TEST 17

**Real Exam 2026 · Set B**

Neighbourhood, friends and evenings · Studying alone and studying in a group · Setting yourself a goal · Teaching handwriting

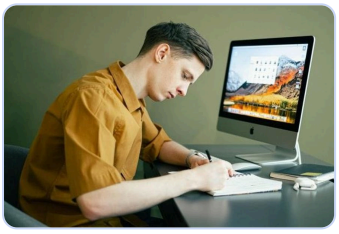
## PART 1.1 — Personal questions

**Answer the questions about yourself. Speak for about 30 seconds each.**

1. **Can you describe the area where you live?**
   ⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s
2. **Who is your closest friend and why?**
   ⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s
3. **How do you usually spend your evenings?**
   ⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

## PART 1.2 — Compare two pictures

**Look at the two pictures and answer the questions.**





4. **What do you see in these pictures?**
   ⏱ 10 s · 🎙 45 s
5. **What are the advantages of studying on your own?**
   ⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s
6. **Why do many students learn better in a group?**
   ⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

## PART 2 — Long turn

**Look at the picture and talk about the topic. You have 1 minute to prepare and 2 minutes to speak.**



**Talk about:**

- Describe an ambitious goal that you set for yourself.
- How did it affect your personal and your professional life?
- Are there any drawbacks to being a very ambitious person?

⏱ 1 min · 🎙 2 min

## PART 3 — Discussion

**Give a balanced argument for and against the statement, then give your own opinion. 1 minute to prepare, 2 minutes to speak.**

**"Handwriting should still be taught in schools."**

| FOR | AGAINST |
|---|---|
| writing by hand helps children remember what they learn | almost all adult work is now done on a keyboard |
| develops fine motor control and concentration | those hours could be spent on digital skills instead |
| pen and paper always work, with no battery or signal | typing is faster and far easier for everyone to read |

⏱ 1 min · 🎙 2 min

**1 Part 1.1 Can you describe the area where you live?**

Yes, I live in a fairly quiet residential area on the edge of the city. There are apartment blocks, small shops, and a park nearby, so it feels comfortable and practical. I like it because everything I need is within walking distance, but it is still peaceful enough to relax in the evenings after a busy day.

**2 Part 1.1 Who is your closest friend and why?**

My closest friend is someone I have known since school, and I trust him completely. What makes him special is that he is honest, reliable, and easy to talk to. Even when we disagree, he listens carefully, gives sensible advice, and never judges me, which is rare and valuable.

**3 Part 1.1 How do you usually spend your evenings?**

I usually spend my evenings finishing my homework, helping at home, and then relaxing a bit. If I have energy left, I watch a short video, read, or go for a walk around my neighbourhood. I like keeping my evenings balanced, because it helps me stay productive without feeling exhausted later.

**4 Part 1.2 What do you see in these pictures?**

In the first picture, I see a man sitting alone at a desk and writing in a notebook. There is a large computer beside him, but he seems to be focusing on his handwritten work instead of the screen. In the second picture, several people are sitting closely together around a table and discussing something. So the main difference is that one scene shows individual study, while the other shows group learning and collaboration.

**5 Part 1.2 What are the advantages of studying on your own?**

Studying on your own has several advantages. First, you can learn at your own speed and spend more time on difficult topics without feeling embarrassed. Second, you do not depend on other people's schedules, which makes it much more flexible and convenient. I also think it helps you become more independent and responsible, because you have to organise your own work and solve problems by yourself.

**6 Part 1.2 Why do many students learn better in a group?**

Many students learn better in a group because they can share ideas and explain things to one another in simple language. If one person does not understand something, another can give a clear explanation or a useful example. Group study also makes people more motivated, because working with others can be more active and less boring. For some learners, that social energy really improves concentration and results.

**7 Part 2 Describe an ambitious goal that you set for yourself.**

One ambitious goal I set for myself was to improve my English enough to speak confidently in public and use it for study and work. I decided on this goal because I realised that English could open many doors for me, especially in education and career opportunities. At first, it felt quite challenging, but I made a clear plan and tried to practise a little every day. I watched videos, read short articles, learned new vocabulary, and spoke even when I made mistakes. Over time, that ambition changed both my personal and professional life in very positive ways. Personally, I became more disciplined, more patient, and much more confident in myself. I stopped being afraid of difficult tasks, because I had proof that steady effort really works. Professionally, my English improved my communication skills and made me more interested in international opportunities and future jobs. It also helped me understand that ambition is useful when it pushes you to grow rather than just to compete with other people. Of course, there are drawbacks to being very ambitious. Sometimes ambitious people become too stressed, impatient, or disappointed if progress is slower than expected. They can also forget to rest or enjoy the present moment. So I think ambition is a great quality, but only if it is balanced with patience, self-care, and realistic expectations.

**8 Part 3 Handwriting should still be taught in schools.**

The statement is that handwriting should still be taught in schools, and I mostly agree with it. On the one hand, writing by hand can help children remember information better, because the process is slower and more active than typing. It also develops fine motor control and concentration, which are useful skills for young learners in many other subjects too. Another practical advantage is that pen and paper always work, even when there is no battery, internet connection, or signal, so they are reliable in any situation. On the other hand, there are strong arguments against spending too much time on handwriting. In adult life, almost all work is done on keyboards, so schools should prepare students for that reality and give more space to digital skills. Also, those lesson hours could be used for learning technology, which is increasingly important in education and employment. And to be honest, typing is usually faster and much easier for other people to read, which saves time and avoids confusion. In my opinion, handwriting should not disappear completely, but it should be taught in a balanced way. I think young students need enough practice to write clearly and confidently, but schools should not treat it as more important than digital literacy. A modern education should give children both skills, because they will need both in different parts of life.

MULTILEVEL · SPEAKING

# TEST 18

**Real Exam 2026 · Set B**

Room, health and routine · How older and younger people spend time · Forgiving someone · Keeping pets

## PART 1.1 — Personal questions

**Answer the questions about yourself. Speak for about 30 seconds each.**

1. **Tell me about your room.**
   ⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s
2. **What do you do to stay healthy?**
   ⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s
3. **Do you usually get up early or late?**
   ⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

## PART 1.2 — Compare two pictures

**Look at the two pictures and answer the questions.**





4. **What do you see in these pictures?**
   ⏱ 10 s · 🎙 45 s
5. **How do older and younger people spend their free time differently?**
   ⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s
6. **What can younger people learn from spending time with older people?**
   ⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

## PART 2 — Long turn

**Look at the picture and talk about the topic. You have 1 minute to prepare and 2 minutes to speak.**



**Talk about:**

- **Describe a time when you forgave someone, or someone forgave you.**
- **What had happened between you?**
- **Why is forgiveness important in a family or a friendship?**

⏱ 1 min · 🎙 2 min

## PART 3 — Discussion

**Give a balanced argument for and against the statement, then give your own opinion. 1 minute to prepare, 2 minutes to speak.**

**"Keeping a pet improves a person's quality of life."**

| FOR | AGAINST |
|---|---|
| offers companionship and real emotional support | pets cost money and need daily time and attention |
| teaches responsibility, routine and patience | unsuitable for small flats or very busy households |
| owners walk more and are generally more active | losing a pet causes genuine and lasting distress |

⏱ 1 min · 🎙 2 min

**1 Part 1.1 Tell me about your room.**

I'd say my room is quite simple but comfortable. I have a bed, a desk and a bookshelf, and I usually keep it tidy because I can think better in a clean space. I also like having a few photos and small things that make it feel personal, so it doesn't look too empty. It's the place where I study, relax and switch off after a long day.

**2 Part 1.1 What do you do to stay healthy?**

To stay healthy, I try to eat balanced food, drink enough water and move around every day. I don't always do intense exercise, but I walk a lot and sometimes do a short workout at home. I think regular habits matter more than doing something extreme once in a while, because small choices every day really add up.

**3 Part 1.1 Do you usually get up early or late?**

I usually get up early on weekdays because I have school or other responsibilities. On weekends I tend to wake up later, especially if I've had a busy week. For me, early mornings are better for work, but I also enjoy a slower start when I have free time. If I sleep well, I can concentrate much better during the day.

**4 Part 1.2 What do you see in these pictures?**

In the first picture, I can see a group of adults sitting around a table and playing cards. They look relaxed and happy, and the atmosphere seems very friendly. In the second picture, there are several young people sitting outside, probably on a campus, chatting and using a phone or reading. The first group looks like older people spending time together indoors, while the second group seems younger and more casual outdoors, so the mood and setting are quite different.

**5 Part 1.2 How do older and younger people spend their free time differently?**

Older and younger people often spend their free time differently because their interests and energy levels are not the same. Younger people usually prefer social media, sports or hanging out with friends, while older people may enjoy quieter activities like chatting, playing games or taking a walk. Of course, there is overlap, but the younger group is often more active and digital, whereas older people tend to choose calmer leisure, especially when they want to relax after work.

**6 Part 1.2 What can younger people learn from spending time with older people?**

Younger people can learn a lot from older people, especially patience, life experience and the ability to see problems in a calmer way. Older people often know how to handle difficulties because they have already been through many situations. I also think younger people can learn respect and communication from them. Just talking regularly with older people can give you useful advice for real life, and sometimes one simple conversation can change your view completely.

**7 Part 2 Describe a time when you forgave someone, or someone forgave you.**

I remember a time when I forgave my close friend after a serious misunderstanding. We had planned to prepare a school project together, but at the last minute he didn't show up and didn't answer my messages. I was angry because I thought he had ignored me on purpose, and I finished the work alone. I honestly felt disappointed and a little embarrassed, because I had trusted him completely and expected him to be there.

A few days later, he explained that his father had taken him to another city because of a family emergency, and his phone battery had died. He was really upset, and I could see that he had not meant to let me down. What helped me forgive him was his honesty and the fact that he apologised sincerely. He didn't make excuses; he simply told me the truth, and that made a big difference.

I realised that if I held onto my anger, our friendship would only become weaker. In the end, I told him that I understood and that we could move on. I think forgiveness is very important in a family or a friendship because nobody is perfect. People make mistakes, sometimes without meaning to hurt us. If you forgive, you protect trust and create a chance to start again. Of course, forgiveness doesn't mean pretending nothing happened, but it does mean choosing the relationship over resentment.

**8 Part 3 Keeping a pet improves a person's quality of life.**

I agree with the idea that keeping a pet improves a person's quality of life, although I think it depends on the situation. On the one hand, pets give companionship and emotional support. For someone who lives alone, a dog or even a cat can make the home feel warmer and less lonely. They are often good listeners in their own way, and just being around an animal can reduce stress. Pets also teach responsibility, because you have to feed them, clean up after them and keep a routine. In addition, dog owners usually walk more, so they become more active without even planning a workout.

On the other hand, pets are not always practical. They cost money for food, vet visits and other care, and they need daily attention. If a person is very busy or lives in a small flat, it can be difficult to give an animal enough space and time. Also, although people don't always think about it, losing a pet can be genuinely painful and can stay with you for a long time. That emotional cost is real and should not be ignored.

For me, the benefits are stronger than the disadvantages if someone is prepared. I think a pet can improve daily life a lot, but only when the owner is ready for the responsibility and understands that caring for an animal is a long-term commitment. In other words, a pet is not just a hobby; it becomes part of the family.

MULTILEVEL · SPEAKING

# TEST 19

**Real Exam 2026 · Set B**

Family time, home and food · Free time alone and with other people · A regret you have · Animals in zoos

## PART 1.1 — Personal questions

🎙️ **Answer the questions about yourself. Speak for about 30 seconds each.**

**1** Do you usually spend much time with your family?
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

**2** Describe your bedroom.
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

**3** What is your favourite dish?
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

## PART 1.2 — Compare two pictures

🖼️ **Look at the two pictures and answer the questions.**





**4** What do you see in these pictures?
⏱ 10 s · 🎙 45 s

**5** What are the advantages of spending free time on your own?
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

**6** Why do most people prefer to relax with friends or family?
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

## PART 2 — Long turn

🗣️ **Look at the picture and talk about the topic. You have 1 minute to prepare and 2 minutes to speak.**



**Talk about:**

- Describe something in your life that you regret.
- What would you do differently if you could go back?
- Can regret ever have a positive effect on a person?

⏱ 1 min · 🎙 2 min

## PART 3 — Discussion

⚖️ **Give a balanced argument for and against the statement, then give your own opinion. 1 minute to prepare, 2 minutes to speak.**

**"Animals should be kept in their natural habitat, not in zoos."**

| FOR | AGAINST |
|---|---|
| animals live freely and behave naturally in the wild | zoos protect and breed endangered species |
| captivity causes stress and unnatural behaviour | they teach the public to care about wildlife |
| it respects animal rights and prevents mistreatment | scientists can study animals closely and safely |

⏱ 1 min · 🎙 2 min

**1 Part 1.1 Do you usually spend much time with your family?**

Yes, I do, especially in the evenings and at weekends. We try to have dinner together or just talk about our day, because that helps us stay close even when we are all busy. I think those little conversations are important, since they make family life feel supportive and warm, not just routine. In a fast-paced life, that regular contact really matters to me.

**2 Part 1.1 Describe your bedroom.**

My bedroom is quite simple and comfortable. I have a bed, a desk, a wardrobe and a small bookshelf, and I like it because it feels calm and private, which helps me relax after a long day. I also keep it tidy most of the time, because I focus much better when everything has its place and the room does not feel crowded.

**3 Part 1.1 What is your favourite dish?**

My favourite dish is plov, because it is filling and has a rich flavour. I especially enjoy it when it is cooked at family gatherings, since the smell and the atmosphere make it taste even better. It also reminds me of celebrations, so it feels special, not just delicious. For me, it is one of those meals that always feels like home.

**4 Part 1.2 What do you see in these pictures?**

In the first picture, I can see a woman sitting alone on a bench in a park by the water. It looks peaceful and autumnal, with trees around her and fallen leaves on the ground. In the second picture, a group of friends is in a cinema, laughing and eating popcorn while watching a film. The main difference is that the first person is spending free time quietly on her own, whereas the second group is enjoying a lively shared experience.

**5 Part 1.2 What are the advantages of spending free time on your own?**

One advantage is that you can do exactly what you want without needing to compromise with anyone. You can read, think, listen to music or just rest in silence, which is often the best way to recharge. It can also help you understand yourself better, because alone time gives you space to reflect on your thoughts and feelings. For me, that kind of quiet time is sometimes the fastest way to recover after a busy week.

**6 Part 1.2 Why do most people prefer to relax with friends or family?**

Most people prefer to relax with friends or family because it feels more enjoyable and emotionally warm. When you share free time with people you care about, you can talk, laugh and create memories together. Also, many activities are simply more fun in company, and being around others can make people feel less stressed and less lonely. That social connection is one of the main reasons people choose company over being alone, especially after a difficult day.

**7 Part 2 Describe something in your life that you regret.**

One thing I regret is not taking my studies seriously enough when I was younger. I used to think there would always be time to catch up, so I sometimes wasted days on unimportant things instead of building good habits. Later, I realised that those missed opportunities were hard to recover, especially when deadlines and exams started to pile up. If I could go back, I would organise my time better, ask for help earlier, and be more disciplined from the beginning. I would also try to worry less about being perfect and focus more on steady progress, because even small steps matter. I think regret can have a positive effect if a person learns from it instead of just feeling bad. For example, regret can push you to change your behaviour, become more responsible, and value your chances more carefully. In my case, regretting wasted time taught me to respect deadlines and to treat every small effort as something important. So although regret is uncomfortable, it can be a useful teacher if we are honest with ourselves and actually act on what we have learned. It may even motivate us to avoid making the same mistake twice, which is why I do not see regret as completely negative.

**8 Part 3 Animals should be kept in their natural habitat, not in zoos.**

The statement says that animals should be kept in their natural habitat, not in zoos. I partly agree with this idea, because there are strong arguments on both sides, and the issue is more complicated than it first appears. On the one hand, animals in the wild can live more freely and behave in ways that are natural to them. They can move over large areas, hunt, socialise and follow their instincts. In zoos, by contrast, many animals experience stress, boredom or strange behaviour because their environment is limited and artificial. From an ethical point of view, keeping animals in captivity can also seem like a form of control that ignores their rights and may lead to mistreatment if conditions are poor or overcrowded. On the other hand, zoos can play an important role in protecting endangered species. Some animals survive today because breeding programmes in captivity have saved them from extinction, and without that help their numbers might have disappeared completely. Zoos also educate the public and can make people care more about wildlife and conservation, especially children who may never see these animals otherwise. In addition, scientists can study animals closely in zoos, which may help them improve protection in the wild and learn more about behaviour and health. Personally, I believe wild habitats are always better for animals, but I think zoos can be justified only when they are truly focused on conservation, education and humane care. They should never exist just for entertainment, because animals are not there for our amusement.

MULTILEVEL · SPEAKING

# TEST 20

**Real Exam 2026 · Set B**

School, routine and weather · Traditional and modern classrooms · Feeling confident in yourself · Online privacy

## PART 1.1 — Personal questions

🎙️ **Answer the questions about yourself. Speak for about 30 seconds each.**

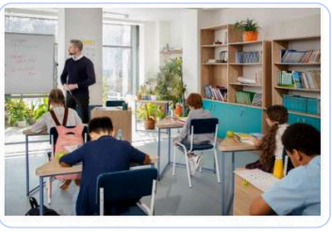
**1** Describe your school or your workplace.
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

**2** What time do you usually wake up?
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

**3** What is the weather like today?
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

## PART 1.2 — Compare two pictures

🖼️ **Look at the two pictures and answer the questions.**





**4** What do you see in these pictures?
⏱ 10 s · 🎙 45 s

**5** What are the advantages of a modern, flexible classroom?
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

**6** Why do many teachers still prefer a traditional classroom?
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

## PART 2 — Long turn

🗣️ **Look at the picture and talk about the topic. You have 1 minute to prepare and 2 minutes to speak.**



**Talk about:**

- Describe a time when you felt truly confident in yourself.
- What had given you that confidence?
- How can a person build real self-confidence?

⏱ 1 min · 🎙 2 min

## PART 3 — Discussion

⚖️ **Give a balanced argument for and against the statement, then give your own opinion. 1 minute to prepare, 2 minutes to speak.**

**"Online privacy is more important than national security."**

| FOR | AGAINST |
|---|---|
| privacy is a basic right of every citizen | monitoring helps prevent terrorism and organised crime |
| collected data can be leaked, stolen or misused | online data protects children from exploitation |
| mass surveillance rarely stops serious crime | honest people lose very little by being checked |

⏱ 1 min · 🎙 2 min

**1 Part 1.1 Describe your school or your workplace.**

I'd describe my school as a busy but friendly place where students are encouraged to work hard, ask questions and support one another. We have modern classrooms, a small library and teachers who are usually supportive and patient. I like it because the atmosphere is positive, so it is easier to stay motivated, improve and feel confident.

**2 Part 1.1 What time do you usually wake up?**

I usually wake up at around 7 a.m. on weekdays because that gives me enough time to get ready calmly and have breakfast before I start my day. If I wake up too late, I feel rushed and unsettled, and that makes it harder to concentrate properly during the morning lessons.

**3 Part 1.1 What is the weather like today?**

Today the weather looks fairly mild and pleasant, though it seems a bit cloudy. I'd probably call it comfortable rather than hot or cold, so it feels quite easy to go outside. Weather like this is actually nice because it makes studying, travelling or walking around much more comfortable.

**4 Part 1.2 What do you see in these pictures?**

In the first picture, I can see a teacher standing in front of a few students in a modern classroom. The room is bright and tidy, with bookshelves, plants and separate desks for each student. In the second picture, there is a more traditional classroom where the teacher is at the front and several children are raising their hands. Both pictures show learning, but the first one looks more flexible and open, while the second feels more formal and structured.

**5 Part 1.2 What are the advantages of a modern, flexible classroom?**

A modern, flexible classroom has a lot of advantages for both students and teachers. It usually feels brighter, more comfortable and less restrictive than a traditional room. The furniture can be moved around, so it is easier to work in pairs or groups, or even do different activities during one lesson. I think that kind of space encourages creativity, movement and participation, so students often feel more engaged and confident.

**6 Part 1.2 Why do many teachers still prefer a traditional classroom?**

Many teachers still prefer a traditional classroom because it is easier to control and organise. When all the desks face the teacher, it is simpler for students to focus on the explanation, especially during a grammar lesson or a test. It also creates a clear sense of order and discipline, which can be very useful. For some subjects, and for younger learners too, that familiar structure works really well.

**7 Part 2 Describe a time when you felt truly confident in yourself.**

I felt truly confident in myself when I gave a short presentation in English at school last year. I still remember that day clearly because I had always been nervous about speaking in front of other people. Before the lesson, I prepared carefully, practised my words at home several times and tried to imagine the questions my classmates might ask. I also wrote a few key ideas on small notes, just in case I forgot something. When I stood up and started speaking, I was afraid at first, but after the first minute I relaxed a little. I noticed that people were listening attentively and some of them were even nodding, which encouraged me more. By the end of the presentation, I answered the teacher's questions without hesitation, and that made me feel proud of myself.

What gave me that confidence was a combination of preparation and support. I knew my topic well, so I was not completely guessing, and one of my close friends had encouraged me before the lesson, which helped calm my nerves. Also, I had improved my English gradually over time, so I could actually see progress in myself instead of just hoping to do well.

I think a person builds real self-confidence by setting small goals and achieving them step by step. It also helps to learn from mistakes instead of being ashamed of them. When people practise regularly, accept feedback and remind themselves of their strengths, confidence grows naturally and becomes much more stable and real.

**8 Part 3 Online privacy is more important than national security.**

This statement is very relevant today because almost everything we do online leaves some kind of digital trace. On the one hand, online privacy is a basic right, and people should not feel constantly watched just because they use the internet. Our personal data can be leaked, stolen or misused by companies or criminals, and once that happens, the damage can be long-lasting. Supporters of privacy also argue that mass surveillance rarely stops serious crime, because determined criminals often find ways around it.

On the other hand, people who support security say that monitoring can help prevent terrorism and organised crime before innocent people are harmed. It can also protect children from exploitation online, which is a very serious issue. In addition, some people believe that honest citizens lose very little if their activity is checked, especially when the aim is public safety.

Personally, I think privacy should be the priority, but not in an absolute sense. Governments need to collect some data, but only with clear rules, strong legal control and real transparency. If surveillance becomes too broad, it can damage trust and create more risks than it solves. So I support limited monitoring, but only when it is necessary and carefully controlled.

## PART 1.1 — Personal questions

🎙️ **Answer the questions about yourself. Speak for about 30 seconds each.**

1. **Where do you like to go to in your free time?**
   ⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s
2. **Do you work or study?**
   ⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s
3. **Do you like listening to music?**
   ⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

## PART 1.2 — Compare two pictures

🖼️ **Look at the two pictures and answer the questions.**





4. **What do you see in these pictures?**
   ⏱ 10 s · 🎙 45 s
5. **Why do some people like to eat fast food?**
   ⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s
6. **Do you think breakfast is important?**
   ⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

## PART 2 — Long turn

🗣️ **Look at the picture and talk about the topic. You have 1 minute to prepare and 2 minutes to speak.**



**Talk about:**

- Tell me about a skill you have learned recently.
- Why is it important nowadays?
- Give an example of when you use this skill.

⏱ 1 min · 🎙 2 min

## PART 3 — Discussion

⚖️ **Give a balanced argument for and against the statement, then give your own opinion. 1 minute to prepare, 2 minutes to speak.**

**"The arts should be supported by the government."**

| FOR | AGAINST |
|---|---|
| People can learn from art | Funding could be better granted to education and the healthcare system |
| Art encourages creativity and promotes harmony in society | Art does not play a vital role in society |
| The government is responsible for protecting the culture | Artists should earn their own living |

⏱ 1 min · 🎙 2 min

**1 Part 1.1 Where do you like to go to in your free time?**

I enjoy spending my free time in a variety of ways, but I'm particularly drawn to places that offer a sense of tranquility and rejuvenation. For example, I often visit the local park, where I can take a leisurely stroll, enjoy the fresh air, and observe nature. I also find museums to be incredibly stimulating environments, as they expose me to new ideas and perspectives. And of course, I always appreciate spending time with friends and family, whether it's catching a movie or simply having a meal together.

**2 Part 1.1 Do you work or study?**

Right now, I'm focusing on my studies, which is keeping me quite busy. I'm currently pursuing a degree in English Literature, and I'm really enjoying the challenges and opportunities that come with it. The academic environment is very stimulating, and I'm constantly learning and expanding my knowledge.

**3 Part 1.1 Do you like listening to music?**

Absolutely! Music is an integral part of my life, and I enjoy listening to a wide range of genres. I'm particularly fond of pop and soul music for their energy, emotional depth, complexity. Music has the power to uplift my mood, provide comfort, and inspire creativity. I find myself listening to music almost every day, whether it's while I'm studying, working out, or simply relaxing at home.

**4 Part 1.2 What do you see in these pictures?**

The first picture shows a mother and her young daughter enjoying a meal together in a restaurant, probably a fast-food place. They're both smiling and seem relaxed, and the mother's got a classic burger and fries, while her daughter has her own meal. There's a glass of juice for refreshment, which adds to the casual, fun atmosphere that you often get when dining out. The second picture, on the other hand, shows a woman preparing a meal in her kitchen. She's carefully arranging fresh vegetables on her kitchen table, likely to chop them up for a dish. This picture really highlights the methodical and purposeful nature of home cooking.

**5 Part 1.2 Why do some people like to eat fast food?**

There are several reasons why people are drawn to fast food. Convenience is a major factor. Fast food restaurants are readily available and offer quick service, appealing to busy individuals with limited time. The affordability of fast food also makes it an attractive option, particularly for those on a budget. Additionally, the familiar flavors and textures of fast food can be comforting and satisfying, offering a quick escape from the everyday. However, it's important to note that fast food is often high in calories, fat, and sodium, and consuming it regularly can have negative health implications.

**6 Part 1.2 Do you think breakfast is important?**

I firmly believe that breakfast is an essential meal of the day. It provides the body with vital nutrients and energy after a long night of rest. This can improve concentration, focus, and overall energy levels throughout the day. Studies have shown that people who eat breakfast tend to have healthier eating habits overall and may even be less likely to be overweight or obese. While I understand that some people don't have time for a full breakfast, even a simple snack like a piece of fruit or a yogurt can be a helpful way to start the day.

**7 Part 2 Tell me about a skill you have learned recently.**

Recently, I've been really dedicated to improving my English language skills. I've always been interested in different cultures and languages, and English is the global language of communication. I've been taking online courses that focus on both grammar and vocabulary, and I've been making a conscious effort to practice speaking with native speakers. It's been a challenging yet rewarding journey, and I'm really pleased with how much my fluency and confidence have improved. I'm now able to express myself more clearly and effectively, which is crucial for my personal and professional growth." "In today's globalized world, English proficiency is essential for countless aspects of life. It opens doors to a wider range of opportunities in education, employment, and travel. It allows individuals to connect with people from diverse cultures, access information from around the world, and thrive in an increasingly interconnected society. It's not just about being able to communicate, it's about being able to understand and engage with different perspectives and ideas." "Just the other day, I was participating in an online discussion forum about current events. It was fascinating to see how people from all over the world shared their viewpoints and engaged in respectful debate. I was able to contribute my own thoughts and perspectives, and I learned a lot from the different perspectives shared. This experience really highlighted the importance of effective communication and how English can be a bridge to understanding different cultures and perspectives.

**8 Part 3 The arts should be supported by the government.**

The argument for government support of the arts rests on the undeniable value it brings to society. Beyond mere entertainment, art serves as a powerful educational tool, fostering critical thinking and diverse perspectives. A visit to a museum can transport viewers to distant times and cultures, broadening their horizons and enriching their understanding of the world. Additionally, art promotes creativity and innovation, vital qualities for individual and societal progress. Whether through painting, music, or theatre, art encourages expression and imagination, sparking new ideas and fostering a vibrant and dynamic cultural landscape. Moreover, governments have a responsibility to protect and preserve cultural heritage, and art plays a central role in this endeavor. By supporting artistic endeavors, governments ensure the continuation of a rich tapestry of traditions, stories, and expressions that define a nation's identity. While the merits of art are undeniable, opponents argue that government funding should be prioritized for essential services like education and healthcare. They maintain that art, while enriching, is a luxury that individuals can support through private patronage. In their view, art does not play a vital role in society, and artists should be able to earn a living through their craft, just like any other profession. They argue that government resources are better allocated to areas that directly impact the well-being and economic prosperity of citizens, leaving art to thrive or fail based on its inherent value and the support it receives from individuals and private organizations.

## PART 1.1 — Personal questions

**Answer the questions about yourself. Speak for about 30 seconds each.**

1. **Do you live in a flat or a house?**
   ⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s
2. **What is your favorite animal?**
   ⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s
3. **Do you like sport?**
   ⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

## PART 1.2 — Compare two pictures

**Look at the two pictures and answer the questions.**





4. **What do you see in these pictures?**
   ⏱ 10 s · 🎙 45 s
5. **What are the advantages of online learning?**
   ⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s
6. **What are the advantages of traditional studying?**
   ⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

## PART 2 — Long turn

**Look at the picture and talk about the topic. You have 1 minute to prepare and 2 minutes to speak.**



- Tell me about a critical decision you have made.
- How has this decision influenced you and your life?
- What factors have the highest impact on the decisions people make?

**Talk about:**

- **Tell me about a critical decision you have made.**
- **How has this decision influenced you and your life?**
- **What factors have the highest impact on the decisions people make?**

⏱ 1 min · 🎙 2 min

## PART 3 — Discussion

**Give a balanced argument for and against the statement, then give your own opinion. 1 minute to prepare, 2 minutes to speak.**

**"Single-use plastic should be banned."**

| FOR | AGAINST |
|---|---|
| Cleaner environment | Single-use things are cheaper |
| Saves animals | It can be hard to find reusable options for everything |
| Less waste | Some people might lose their jobs in companies |

⏱ 1 min · 🎙 2 min

## MODEL ANSWERS — C1 model answers · book

**1 Part 1.1 Do you live in a flat or a house?**

I live in a flat, actually. It's quite cozy and practical for me. I enjoy having easy access to amenities and the convenience of living in a central location. While I appreciate the spaciousness of a house, I think a flat suits my lifestyle better, especially since I enjoy spending time exploring the city and connecting with friends.

**2** **Part 1.1** **What is your favorite animal?**

I'm a big fan of dolphins! They're so intelligent and playful. I love watching documentaries about them and learning about how they communicate and work together. They're also fascinating creatures because they're so adaptable and can thrive in different environments. I think their playful nature and strong social bonds are quite inspiring.

**3** **Part 1.1** **Do you like sport?**

I'm a big sports fan! I love watching football and basketball. I find it really exciting to see athletes pushing their limits and working together as a team. I also enjoy the strategic side of the game and how it involves both physical skill and mental strategy. It's a great way to unwind and get swept up in the action.

**4** **Part 1.2** **What do you see in these pictures?**

These pictures illustrate two contrasting approaches to learning: traditional classroom instruction and the increasingly popular online learning environment. The first picture evokes a sense of warmth and community, with students engaged in a traditional classroom setting. The children's focused expressions and sparkling eyes suggest active participation and a genuine interest in their teacher's instruction. It highlights the importance of face-to-face interaction and the role of a teacher as a guide and facilitator of learning. The second picture, however, depicts a more solitary experience, with a student focused intently on an online learning platform. The use of headphones emphasizes the individual nature of online learning and the reliance on technology. While it offers flexibility and access to a vast array of resources, it raises questions about the potential for isolation and the importance of fostering a sense of community among online learners.

**5** **Part 1.2** **What are the advantages of online learning?**

Online learning has become incredibly popular, and for good reason. One of the biggest advantages is its flexibility. You can study at your own pace, from anywhere in the world, which is great for busy people or those with family commitments. Additionally, online platforms offer a wealth of resources and information that might not be readily available in traditional settings. You can also find specialized courses and connect with a global community of learners.

**6** **Part 1.2** **What are the advantages of traditional studying?**

Traditional learning in a classroom setting still holds its own. It provides a structured learning environment, with clear deadlines and direct interaction with professors. This structure can be beneficial for some learners who prefer a more disciplined approach. Additionally, traditional classrooms offer the opportunity for face-to-face interaction with peers, fostering collaboration and a sense of community. The social aspect can be very valuable for many students.

**7** **Part 2** **Tell me about a critical decision you have made.**

One of the most critical decisions I made was choosing to pursue a master's degree abroad. At the time, I was weighing the pros and cons of continuing my education in my home country versus venturing into an international environment. Ultimately, I decided that studying abroad would not only enhance my academic credentials but also broaden my cultural horizons and professional network. This choice was pivotal, as it exposed me to diverse perspectives and methodologies, significantly enriching my understanding of my field. This decision has profoundly influenced both my personal and professional development. Academically, I acquired advanced knowledge and skills that have set me apart in the job market. On a personal level, living in a foreign country challenged me to adapt to new cultures and navigate various social dynamics, fostering resilience and independence. Additionally, the friendships I formed with individuals from different backgrounds have enriched my life immeasurably, providing me with a global perspective that informs my worldview. Overall, this experience has instilled in me a lifelong passion for learning and exploration. Several factors significantly impact the decisions people make, with personal values and life experiences often being paramount. Individuals tend to base their choices on what aligns with their core beliefs and priorities. Additionally, social influences, such as family expectations and peer pressure, can heavily sway decisions, particularly in formative years. Economic considerations also play a crucial role; for instance, financial stability can dictate career choices or educational pursuits. Finally, emotional factors—such as fear of failure or desire for security—often complicate decision-making processes, leading individuals to weigh risks against potential rewards carefully.

**8 Part 3 Single-use plastic should be banned.**

A ban on single-use plastic would bring about significant environmental benefits. Firstly, it would dramatically reduce plastic waste, mitigating the detrimental impact of plastic pollution on our oceans, beaches, and wildlife. The presence of plastic debris in our ecosystems not only disrupts the natural balance but also poses a threat to marine life through ingestion and entanglement. Secondly, a ban would encourage the adoption of sustainable alternatives, such as reusable bags, containers, and biodegradable packaging. This shift towards eco-friendly options would minimize our reliance on fossil fuels and reduce the carbon footprint associated with plastic production. Finally, banning single-use plastic would promote a circular economy, where resources are used more efficiently, minimizing waste and promoting resource conservation. This shift towards a more sustainable model of consumption is essential for safeguarding our planet for future generations. Despite the potential benefits, banning single-use plastic also presents some challenges. Firstly, it could lead to economic disruption for industries reliant on plastic production and packaging. This could result in job losses and price increases for consumers as companies transition to more sustainable alternatives. Secondly, a ban could pose challenges for affordability and accessibility, particularly for low-income communities. Reusable alternatives can often be more expensive than single-use options, potentially exacerbating existing inequalities. Finally, implementing a comprehensive ban would require significant infrastructure development, consumer education, and robust enforcement mechanisms. Ensuring effective implementation across different sectors and communities would be a complex task, requiring substantial investment and coordination.

# TEST 23



## PART 1.1 — Personal questions

🎙️ **Answer the questions about yourself. Speak for about 30 seconds each.**

**1** When do you usually listen to music?
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

**2** What do you do to stay healthy?
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

**3** Tell me about your school.
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

## PART 1.2 — Compare two pictures

🖼️ **Look at the two pictures and answer the questions.**





**4** What do you see in these pictures?
⏱ 10 s · 🎙 45 s

**5** What is the advantage of buying products from local farmers over the supermarket?
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

**6** What is the advantage of buying products from a supermarket?
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

## PART 2 — Long turn

🗣️ **Look at the picture and talk about the topic. You have 1 minute to prepare and 2 minutes to speak.**



**Talk about:**

- Describe a special meal that someone prepared for you.
- Who cooked it for you?
- How did you feel about it?

⏱ 1 min · 🎙 2 min

## PART 3 — Discussion

⚖️ **Give a balanced argument for and against the statement, then give your own opinion. 1 minute to prepare, 2 minutes to speak.**

**"Students should wear uniforms at school."**

| FOR | AGAINST |
|---|---|
| School uniforms promote a sense of equality among students | School uniforms can be expensive |
| Students are less likely to be preoccupied with their appearance or compare themselves to others | Uniforms may not always be comfortable |
| Uniforms create a strong sense of unity | The same clothes limit pupils' ability to express themselves through their clothing choices |

⏱ 1 min · 🎙 2 min

**1 Part 1.1 When do you usually listen to music?**

I find myself listening to music most often when I'm winding down after a busy day. It helps me to relax and de-stress, especially after work or studying. I also enjoy listening to music while I'm exercising, as it provides a great motivational boost and helps me to stay focused.

**2 Part 1.1 What do you do to stay healthy?**

Maintaining a healthy lifestyle is important to me. I try to eat a balanced diet, focusing on fresh fruits, vegetables, and whole grains. I also prioritize regular exercise, aiming for at least 30 minutes of physical activity most days of the week. I find that a combination of cardio and strength training helps to keep me fit and energized.

**3 Part 1.1 Tell me about your school.**

I attended a large, public high school with a diverse student population. It was known for its strong academic programs and extracurricular activities. The teachers were dedicated and supportive, creating a positive learning environment. While the school was quite large, I was fortunate to find a close group of friends who shared similar interests.

**4 Part 1.2 What do you see in these pictures?**

Both images represent distinct shopping experiences. The first image highlights the convenience of supermarkets, where families can shop together in a comfortable environment. Supermarkets often offer a wide range of products under one roof, making it easier for families to find everything they need in one trip. In contrast, the second image features a street market; bustling with activity and showcasing a variety of fresh fruits and people are engaging with one another while exploring different stalls.

**5 Part 1.2 What is the advantage of buying products from local farmers over the supermarket?**

Buying directly from local farmers offers several advantages over supermarket shopping. Firstly, it promotes sustainability by supporting local businesses and reducing the environmental impact of long- distance transportation. Secondly, you often get fresher, higher-quality produce, as it hasn't traveled long distances and is picked at peak ripeness. Additionally, interacting with the farmers themselves allows you to learn about their practices and ask questions about their products, building a stronger connection to your food source.

**6 Part 1.2 What is the advantage of buying products from a supermarket?**

Supermarkets provide a convenient and readily accessible option for purchasing a wide range of goods. They offer a vast selection of products from various brands and regions, catering to diverse dietary needs and preferences. Additionally, supermarkets are often conveniently located, with extended opening hours and a variety of payment methods. This convenience, coupled with the wide selection, makes them a popular choice for many shoppers.

**7 Part 2 Describe a special meal that someone prepared for you.**

One special meal that stands out in my memory was prepared by my mother on my birthday last year. She decided to cook my favorite dish: a classic homemade chicken curry, accompanied by fragrant rice and fresh bread. My mother has always been an incredible cook, and her chicken curry is something I've cherished since childhood. The moment I walked into the kitchen, the aroma of spices filled the air, instantly making my mouth water. She spent hours preparing the meal, carefully selecting the freshest ingredients and blending them to perfection. When we finally sat down to eat, I felt a wave of warmth and happiness. It wasn't just about the delicious food; it was also about the love and effort she put into making my birthday special. Sharing that meal with my family made it even more meaningful. We laughed, reminisced, and enjoyed each other's company, creating memories that I will hold dear. Overall, this meal was more than just sustenance; it was a heartfelt expression of love from my mother. It reminded me of the importance of family traditions and the joy that comes from sharing good food with loved ones.

**8** **Part 3** **Students should wear uniforms at school.**

On one hand, school uniforms offer a number of benefits. They promote a sense of equality among students, regardless of their background or socioeconomic status. When everyone is dressed alike, there's less pressure to conform to expensive trends or feel inferior because of their clothing. This can create a more focused learning environment, as students are less likely to be preoccupied with their appearance or comparing themselves to others. Uniforms also foster a sense of unity and belonging within the school community, creating a shared identity that reinforces school values and traditions. However, the argument against school uniforms highlights a few drawbacks. Firstly, uniforms can be expensive, especially for families with multiple children. This can be a financial burden, particularly for those who are already struggling to make ends meet. Secondly, uniforms may not always be comfortable or practical for all students, especially during different weather conditions or if they participate in physically demanding activities. Perhaps the most significant argument against uniforms is that they limit students' ability to express themselves through their clothing choices. For many, fashion is a form of personal expression, and being forced to wear the same clothes every day can stifle their creativity and individuality.

# TEST 24



## PART 1.1 — Personal questions

**Answer the questions about yourself. Speak for about 30 seconds each.**

1. **Describe your house.**
   ⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s
2. **Do you get up early or late?**
   ⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s
3. **What is your favourite drink?**
   ⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

## PART 1.2 — Compare two pictures

**Look at the two pictures and answer the questions.**





4. **What do you see in these pictures?**
   ⏱ 10 s · 🎙 45 s
5. **What are the benefits of travelling by train?**
   ⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s
6. **Which ways of travelling do you prefer?**
   ⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

## PART 2 — Long turn

**Look at the picture and talk about the topic. You have 1 minute to prepare and 2 minutes to speak.**



**Talk about:**

- Describe a time when you achieved a great goal.
- Describe a person who influenced you.
- How did you feel about this achievement?

⏱ 1 min · 🎙 2 min

## PART 3 — Discussion

**Give a balanced argument for and against the statement, then give your own opinion. 1 minute to prepare, 2 minutes to speak.**

**"Smartphones should be banned in schools."**

| FOR | AGAINST |
|---|---|
| Better focus and learning | Limited access to information |
| More time for real-life activities | Restricted communication |
| Reduced screen time and eye strain | Limited use for educational purposes |

⏱ 1 min · 🎙 2 min

## MODEL ANSWERS — C1 model answers · book

**1 Part 1.1 Describe your house.**

My house is a comfortable two-story terraced house in a quiet neighborhood. It's quite spacious with a cozy living room, a well-equipped kitchen, and a small but sunny garden. I really enjoy spending time in my garden, especially during the warmer months.

**2 Part 1.1 Do you get up early or late?**

I tend to be a bit of a morning person, so I usually wake up quite early, around 7:00 am. It gives me a chance to start my day calmly and have a good breakfast before starting work or my studies.

**3 Part 1.1 What is your favourite drink?**

Actually, my preference in terms of beverages quite diversifies. It depends on what I am having or what I am doing. When I am having lunch, I prefer to drink hot tea rather than fizzy drinks. In contrast, when I am engaged in physical activities, I would like to have mineral water. Or, on chilly days, drinking hot coffee is my cup of tea.

**4** **Part 1.2** **What do you see in these pictures?**

These two images offer a fascinating contrast between two popular modes of travel. In the first, we see passengers boarding an airplane, a method that prioritizes speed and efficiency. While air travel can be expensive, it undeniably saves a considerable amount of time, making it ideal for long-distance journeys or those with tight schedules. In the second image, however, we observe a scenic train journey, where travelers can immerse themselves in breathtaking views. This leisurely pace allows for a more relaxed and enjoyable experience, allowing passengers to truly appreciate the landscapes they pass through. Ultimately, the choice between air and rail travel comes down to personal priorities: time versus tranquility, cost versus scenery.

**5** **Part 1.2** **What are the benefits of travelling by train?**

Trains offer a number of advantages. Firstly, they are often more affordable than other modes of transport, making them accessible to a wider range of travelers. You can also comfortably use your electronic devices, work, or relax during the journey. And unlike planes, train travel is generally not affected by weather conditions, so you can be confident you'll reach your destination. Plus, many trains offer amenities like reclining seats or even sleeping compartments for ultimate comfort. And for people with health concerns like high blood pressure, train travel can be a much less stressful option.

**6** **Part 1.2** **Which ways of travelling do you prefer?**

Honestly, I find myself drawn to different modes of travel depending on the situation. For shorter trips, I enjoy the convenience and speed of driving my own car. However, for longer distances, I favor train travel. I find the opportunity to relax, enjoy the views, and even catch up on some reading during the journey incredibly appealing. Plus, it's a more sustainable choice for the environment. Ultimately, it's about finding the best balance between time, cost, comfort, and my environmental impact.

**7** **Part 2** **Describe a time when you achieved a great goal.**

One of the most satisfying achievements in my life was when I finally bought my first car. It wasn't just about acquiring a vehicle; it represented a culmination of hard work, financial discipline, and a significant step toward independence. From a young age, I'd always envisioned myself driving, exploring new places, and having the freedom to create my own adventures. My father played a pivotal role in shaping my journey. He instilled in me the value of financial responsibility and encouraged me to be proactive in achieving my goals. He didn't just hand me the keys; he guided me through the process, teaching me how to research different models, negotiate with dealerships, and even understand the intricacies of car insurance. It was a steep learning curve, but his unwavering support and pragmatic advice made the entire experience enriching. When I finally signed the papers and drove my car home, I felt an overwhelming sense of accomplishment. It wasn't just about the car itself, but about the personal growth I experienced. I realized that with determination and a clear vision, I could achieve anything I set my mind to. It was a pivotal moment that instilled in me a confidence I carry with me to this day. The journey to acquiring my first car wasn't just about acquiring a vehicle, it was about becoming a more independent, responsible, and self-assured individual.

**8 Part 3 Smartphones should be banned in schools.**

When students have their phones with them, it's really hard for them to concentrate on their lessons. They're constantly checking messages, scrolling through social media, or playing games. Banning phones would mean students would pay more attention in class, listen to their teachers, and take better notes. This would help them learn more effectively and get better grades. In addition, when students are glued to their phones, they miss out on opportunities to do other things, like playing sports, joining clubs, or spending time with friends. A ban on phones would encourage students to be more active, social, and involved in school life. This would help them develop their social skills, get more exercise, and learn new things outside of the classroom. Finally, constant use of smartphones can lead to eye strain, headaches, and even sleep problems. A ban on phones in school would mean students would spend less time staring at screens, which could improve their overall health and well-being. Despite these plus sides of banning, smartphones can be valuable tools for learning. Students can use them to research information, access educational apps, and even take notes electronically. A ban on phones would restrict their access to these resources, potentially hindering their learning process and putting them at a disadvantage compared to students who have access to these technologies outside of school. Smartphones are essential for communication, especially in emergencies. Banning them could make it harder for students to contact their parents, guardians, or other emergency services if needed. It could also limit their ability to communicate with friends and family in case of unforeseen circumstances. Furthermore, while there are valid concerns about distractions, smartphones can also be utilized as valuable tools for learning. Students can use educational apps, access online resources, or even participate in interactive learning activities through their phones. A blanket ban on phones would disregard these potential benefits and hinder the possibilities for incorporating technology into modern education.

## PART 1.1 — Personal questions

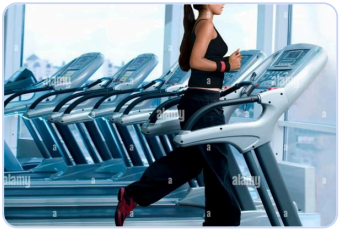
Answer the questions about yourself. Speak for about 30 seconds each.

1. **Do you like listening to music?**
   ⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s
2. **What kind of weather don't you like?**
   ⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s
3. **What do you do after work or school?**
   ⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

## PART 1.2 — Compare two pictures

Look at the two pictures and answer the questions.





4. **What do you see in these pictures?**
   ⏱ 10 s · 🎙 45 s
5. **What are the advantages of doing sport?**
   ⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s
6. **Which is better: doing sport indoors or outdoors?**
   ⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

## PART 2 — Long turn

Look at the picture and talk about the topic. You have 1 minute to prepare and 2 minutes to speak.



**Talk about:**

- Describe a team project that you worked on.
- What was it and what did you do?
- How did you feel about it?

⏱ 1 min · 🎙 2 min

## PART 3 — Discussion

Give a balanced argument for and against the statement, then give your own opinion. 1 minute to prepare, 2 minutes to speak.

**"Online education is better than offline education."**

| FOR | AGAINST |
|---|---|
| Online education offers a greater degree of flexibility | Offline education fosters direct interaction between students and teachers |
| Online platforms offer an abundance of resources | Traditional classrooms provide a structured learning environment with set schedules and routines |
| Online education is often a more cost-effective alternative to traditional education | Offline education gives students opportunities to build meaningful relationships |

⏱ 1 min · 🎙 2 min

**1 Part 1.1 Do you like listening to music?**

Oh absolutely! Music is a huge part of my life. I find it really relaxing to unwind with some tunes after a long day. I especially enjoy listening to soul music, as it is stress reliever activity before going to sleep. And of course, I love going to concerts and live performances whenever I can.

**2 Part 1.1 What kind of weather don't you like?**

Well, I'm not a huge fan of extremely humid weather. It just feels stifling and uncomfortable. I also find it hard to concentrate when it's unbearably hot. I much prefer cooler temperatures and a bit of a breeze. There's nothing quite like a crisp autumn day, for instance.

**3 Part 1.1 What do you do after work or school?**

After work or school, I usually try to de-stress and recharge. I might catch up with friends, grab a bite to eat, or just relax at home. Sometimes I'll indulge in a hobby, like [mention your hobby and briefly explain why you enjoy it]. It's important for me to have some time to unwind and do things I enjoy before the next day begins.

**4 Part 1.2 What do you see in these pictures?**

The images present two different ways of running to keep fit. While the first one features a woman who has a small backpack is running amidst breathtaking mountain scenery. This method helps runner to feel the nature and capture its beauty. In contrast, the second picture shows a woman running on the designated running track in the gym. This method is ideal for city dwellers who may lack access to outdoor running routes to take care of their health.

**5 Part 1.2 What are the advantages of doing sport?**

There are tons of benefits to engaging in sports! First and foremost, it's fantastic for physical health. It strengthens muscles, improves cardiovascular fitness, and helps maintain a healthy weight. But it's not just about the body, it's also great for mental well-being. Sports can boost mood, reduce stress, and even improve sleep quality. Plus, being involved in a team or group can foster a sense of camaraderie and social interaction. So, it's a win-win all around!

**6 Part 1.2 Which is better: doing sport indoors or outdoors?**

Honestly, I think it depends on the individual's preferences and circumstances. I personally enjoy the feeling of fresh air and sunshine when exercising outdoors, and I love the chance to explore different trails or parks. However, indoor sports can be great too, especially when the weather is bad or if you need a controlled environment. Gyms offer a lot of variety and professional guidance. Ultimately, it comes down to what motivates you to get moving.

**7 Part 2 Describe a team project that you worked on.**

One of the most impactful team projects I participated in was during my environmental studies class. We were tasked with researching and debating a pressing global issue related to the worsening state of nature. Our group chose to focus on the alarming increase in plastic pollution, particularly in our oceans. My role in the team was to delve into the scientific research surrounding plastic pollution, focusing on its impact on marine life, ecosystems, and even human health. We uncovered staggering statistics about the sheer volume of plastic entering our oceans each year, and the devastating consequences for seabirds, marine mammals, and coral reefs. It was truly eye-opening to see the scale of the problem and how it was affecting our planet in such profound ways. We then used this research to develop a compelling debate presentation. We presented a series of arguments highlighting the urgency of the issue, the consequences of inaction, and the potential solutions. We explored various approaches, from individual lifestyle changes to policy initiatives aimed at reducing plastic production and promoting sustainable alternatives. During the debate, we engaged in constructive dialogue with other teams, challenging each other's perspectives and building upon shared understandings. The experience was truly impactful. It not only deepened my understanding of the complex environmental challenges we face, but it also ignited a passion for finding solutions. It was incredibly motivating to work alongside my teammates, collaborating to present a well-researched and engaging argument. The debate itself was a powerful learning experience, fostering critical thinking and highlighting the importance of responsible environmental stewardship. It made me realize that even small actions can have a significant impact, and it instilled in me a sense of urgency to become an advocate for environmental protection.

**8** **Part 3** **Online education is better than offline education.**

Admittedly, online studying can offer a wide range of possibilities unlike traditional education. Firstly, it offers a greater degree of flexibility. Students can choose when and where to study, which is especially helpful for those who have jobs or family commitments. This means they can learn at their own pace, making it easier to balance their studies with other responsibilities. Secondly, online platforms provide an abundance of resources. Students have access to video lectures, interactive quizzes, and discussion forums, which can cater to different learning styles. This variety helps students understand the material better and keeps them engaged in their studies. Finally, online education is often more cost-effective than traditional education. Students save money on commuting, housing, and other campus-related expenses. Additionally, many online courses have lower tuition fees, making education more accessible to a wider range of people. On the other hand, offline education has its own advantages that make it a better option for some students. One major benefit is that it fosters direct interaction between students and teachers. In a classroom setting, students can ask questions immediately and receive feedback, which can enhance their understanding of the subject matter. Moreover, traditional classrooms provide a structured learning environment. With set schedules and routines, students are more likely to stay focused and organized. This structure can help those who might struggle with self-discipline when studying online. Lastly, offline education allows students to build meaningful relationships with their peers and instructors. These connections can lead to collaborative learning experiences and networking opportunities that are often harder to achieve in an online format.

## PART 1.1 — Personal questions

🎙️ **Answer the questions about yourself. Speak for about 30 seconds each.**

1. **Who was your first teacher?**
   ⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s
2. **What is your favorite number?**
   ⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s
3. **Tell me about your hometown.**
   ⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

## PART 1.2 — Compare two pictures

🖼️ **Look at the two pictures and answer the questions.**





4. **What do you see in these pictures?**
   ⏱ 10 s · 🎙 45 s
5. **What are the advantages of indoor activities?**
   ⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s
6. **Why do children like indoor activities?**
   ⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

## PART 2 — Long turn

🗣️ **Look at the picture and talk about the topic. You have 1 minute to prepare and 2 minutes to speak.**



**Talk about:**

- **Describe a time when you tried to do something but failed.**
- **When was it and what did you try to do?**
- **Why were you not successful in doing it?**

⏱ 1 min · 🎙 2 min

## PART 3 — Discussion

⚖️ **Give a balanced argument for and against the statement, then give your own opinion. 1 minute to prepare, 2 minutes to speak.**

**"Gardening should be taught at school."**

| FOR | AGAINST |
|---|---|
| Spending time in a garden can be incredibly relaxing for pupils | Schools already have packed schedules, and adding another subject can be challenging |
| Students can learn about planting and growing food | Not all schools have suitable outdoor space for a garden |
| Gardening fosters an appreciation for the natural world | While some students might find gardening engaging, others may not be interested in it |

⏱ 1 min · 🎙 2 min

**1 Part 1.1 Who was your first teacher?**

My first teacher was a kind and patient woman named Mrs. Smith. She taught me in kindergarten, and I remember her fondly for her colourful classroom and the fun activities she planned. She really helped to instill a love of learning in me, and I still remember some of the things she taught us, like the alphabet and basic counting. I think it's important to have a good first teacher because it can set the stage for a positive learning experience later on.

**2 Part 1.1 What is your favorite number?**

My favorite number is 7. It's the number I was born on, so it holds a special significance for me. It also happens to be a lucky number in my culture, which I always find reassuring. I always feel a bit more optimistic when I see the number 7 pop up, even in seemingly random places

**3 Part 1.1 Tell me about your hometown.**

My hometown is Rishtan, located in Fergana. It's medium sized area with historical landmarks, natural beauty, bustling markets. I love my hometown for its friendly people, peaceful atmosphere, vibrant culture. In one words, It's a great place to grow up and a place I'm proud to call home.

**4 Part 1.2 What do you see in these pictures?**

Both pictures present children who are engaging in indoor and outdoor activities. As for the first one, some young children are immersing in the game around the table. Indoor games can ensure that young ones can be occupied with physical activities at any time regardless of the weather conditions. While in the second picture, some children are playing a ball in the yard. Outdoor interactions with peers can help children build good social skills.

**5 Part 1.2 What are the advantages of indoor activities?**

Indoor activities offer a number of advantages, especially in certain climates or during specific seasons. One major benefit is protection from the elements. Whether it's scorching heat, pouring rain, or biting cold, indoor activities provide a comfortable and controlled environment. This can be particularly important for people with health concerns or young children who are more sensitive to extreme weather.

**6 Part 1.2 Why do children like indoor activities?**

Children, with their boundless energy and curiosity, often find indoor activities captivating. One reason is that many indoor spaces are specifically designed to entertain and stimulate young minds. Playgrounds, museums, and even shopping malls offer exciting attractions that keep children engaged and entertained. Another plus side is that Indoor spaces are also often temperature-controlled, providing comfort and protection for little ones.

**7 Part 2 Describe a time when you tried to do something but failed.**

I remember vividly the time I first took the IELTS exam. I was aiming for a Band 7 overall, which I knew would open up a lot of opportunities for me. I diligently studied for months, focusing on all four skills - listening, reading, writing, and speaking. I even joined a preparation course and practiced with past exam papers. I felt confident going into the test, but unfortunately, I didn't achieve my desired score. I fell short in the writing section, only scoring a Band 6.5. It was a huge disappointment, and I was disheartened. Analyzing my results, I realized that my biggest weakness was structuring my essays and using more complex vocabulary effectively. I had a good grasp of grammar and sentence structure, but my essays lacked a strong flow and didn't demonstrate a sophisticated use of language. The experience was a valuable lesson for me. I realized that simply studying the material wasn't enough. I needed to develop a more strategic approach, focusing on areas where I struggled. I signed up for additional writing lessons, studied specific vocabulary related to academic writing, and practiced writing different essay types under timed conditions. This time, I focused on developing strong arguments, clear paragraphing, and using a wider range of vocabulary to express my ideas. It wasn't an easy process, but I eventually achieved my goal of a Band 7 overall. This experience taught me the importance of identifying your weaknesses, seeking help where necessary, and putting in the hard work to improve.

**8** **Part 3** **Gardening should be taught at school.**

Admittedly, if gardening is taught at school, this can bring a number of benefits. One compelling argument for incorporating gardening into school curricula is its potential to foster a sense of well-being and connection to nature. Spending time in a garden can be incredibly relaxing for pupils, providing a much-needed respite from the often stressful environment of the classroom. The act of nurturing plants, observing their growth, and reaping the rewards of their labor can be deeply rewarding, cultivating patience, focus, and a sense of accomplishment. Furthermore, by engaging in hands-on activities in a natural setting, students can develop a greater appreciation for the environment, understand the importance of sustainability, and learn practical skills for cultivating healthy food sources. However, practical considerations may hinder the implementation of gardening programs in schools. A primary concern is the already packed schedules of most schools, with limited time available for additional subjects. Adding another subject, especially one that requires outdoor access and ongoing maintenance, could prove challenging, potentially displacing existing programs or extracurricular activities. Furthermore, not all schools have suitable outdoor space for a garden, particularly in urban areas where land is scarce. Even if space is available, ensuring the necessary resources, such as tools, materials, and ongoing maintenance, can be a significant financial burden. Ultimately, the success of a school garden depends on the commitment of both teachers and students, and not all pupils may find gardening engaging, leading to potential disinterest and lack of participation.

# TEST 27



## PART 1.1 — Personal questions

🎙️ **Answer the questions about yourself. Speak for about 30 seconds each.**

1. **What kind of movies do you like?**
   ⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s
2. **What is your favorite type of weather?**
   ⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s
3. **What do you eat for breakfast?**
   ⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

## PART 1.2 — Compare two pictures

🖼️ **Look at the two pictures and answer the questions.**





4. **What do you see in these pictures?**
   ⏱ 10 s · 🎙 45 s
5. **Why do some people prefer private cars?**
   ⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s
6. **Why do other people prefer public transport?**
   ⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

## PART 2 — Long turn

🗣️ **Look at the picture and talk about the topic. You have 1 minute to prepare and 2 minutes to speak.**



**Talk about:**

- Describe a new skill you would like to learn.
- What is it and why do you need it?
- What should you do to learn it?

⏱ 1 min · 🎙 2 min

## PART 3 — Discussion

⚖️ **Give a balanced argument for and against the statement, then give your own opinion. 1 minute to prepare, 2 minutes to speak.**

**"All countries should adopt a single global language."**

| FOR | AGAINST |
|---|---|
| This would eliminate language barriers | This can lead to the erosion of cultures and local languages |
| This can lead to better cultural exchange and understanding | Not all individuals have the same level of access to education |
| No need for translation services and language learning | It would take many years for every country's population to master a global language |

⏱ 1 min · 🎙 2 min

**1 Part 1.1 What kind of movies do you like?**

I'm a big fan of movies that transport me to another world, you know, the kind that really captivate my imagination. I'm particularly drawn to historical dramas, especially those that explore complex characters and pivotal moments in history. For example, I recently watched a film about the French Revolution, and it really made me think about the social and political forces at play. I also enjoy a good thriller, as long as it keeps me on the edge of my seat and doesn't rely on jump scares. A well-crafted thriller can be incredibly suspenseful and thought-provoking.

**2 Part 1.1 What is your favorite type of weather?**

That's a tough one, as I enjoy different weather for different reasons. I suppose my favorite would have to be a crisp autumn day, with clear blue skies and just a hint of a chill in the air. It's the perfect weather for taking a long walk in the park, enjoying the changing colors of the leaves, and the fresh smell of the air. Of course, a warm summer evening with a gentle breeze is also pretty amazing for relaxing outdoors and enjoying the long daylight hours.

**3 Part 1.1 What do you eat for breakfast?**

My breakfast routine varies depending on my schedule, but I always try to start the day with something nourishing. On weekdays, I usually opt for a quick and easy breakfast of yogurt with granola and fruit. It's packed with protein and fiber, which helps me feel full and energized until lunchtime. On weekends, I have more time to experiment, so I might make a smoothie with spinach, banana, and berries, or maybe some avocado toast with a poached egg. I'm trying to be mindful of my diet, so I always aim for a balanced breakfast that includes a good mix of carbohydrates, protein, and healthy fats.

**4 Part 1.2 What do you see in these pictures?**

These two pictures offer contrasting perspectives on commuting. The first image captures a family traveling comfortably in their own car, suggesting a sense of autonomy and control over their journey. This mode of transport often prioritizes speed and privacy, allowing for a more personalized experience. In contrast, the second picture depicts a group of passengers on a bus, engaged in lively conversation, suggesting a sense of community and connection. Public transport, though potentially less convenient in terms of time and flexibility, is a cost-effective and reliable option, providing accessibility to a wider segment of the population.

**5 Part 1.2 Why do some people prefer private cars?**

People prefer private cars for several reasons, I think. One key factor is convenience. It offers flexibility in terms of scheduling and destination. You can go wherever you want, whenever you want, without relying on a fixed timetable or route. Also, comfort and privacy are often cited as advantages. You can control the temperature, listen to your own music, and avoid the potential crowds on public transport. Of course, safety and security are also important for some people, especially if they are traveling with young children or valuable belongings

**6 Part 1.2 Why do other people prefer public transport?**

There are a lot of benefits to using public transport, especially in busy urban areas. Cost is a major one, as it's usually much cheaper than owning and running a car. It's also environmentally friendly, as it reduces traffic congestion and carbon emissions. Another benefit is reduced stress, especially for commuters who can relax and read or use their phones while traveling. In some cities, it's simply more efficient to get around by public transport, as it's often faster than driving in heavy traffic.

**7 Part 2 Describe a new skill you would like to learn.**

If I could learn a new skill, it would be to master the English language. While I can communicate in English fairly well, I want to achieve a much higher level of fluency and proficiency. For me, it's not just about being able to understand and speak, but also about confidently engaging in complex conversations, expressing myself more creatively, and expanding my professional opportunities. My goal is to become more comfortable using a wider range of vocabulary and grammar, and to be able to express myself more clearly and effectively. This would open doors to new career paths, enable me to connect with people from diverse backgrounds, and allow me to enjoy literature, movies, and music in English to a greater degree. To achieve this, I'd need to immerse myself in the language. I'd start by reading English books and articles regularly, focusing on a variety of genres. I'd also listen to English podcasts and watch movies and TV shows with subtitles. I'd make a conscious effort to speak English whenever possible, even if it means practicing with friends or family. I'd enroll in an online English course to enhance my grammar and vocabulary, and I'd look for opportunities to join English-speaking groups or clubs. I'm confident that with consistent dedication, I can achieve fluency in English and unlock a world of possibilities.

**8 Part 3 All countries should adopt a single global language.**

The idea of adopting a single global language is a compelling one, offering several potential advantages. It would undoubtedly break down communication barriers, fostering smoother collaboration and understanding between individuals and nations. Imagine the efficiency gained in business negotiations, diplomatic talks, and even everyday travel, without the need for translation services. This could also lead to a more unified global community, promoting cultural exchange and reducing misunderstandings. Furthermore, the vast resources currently spent on language learning and translation could be redirected towards other vital areas. However, this seemingly utopian scenario also presents significant challenges. The adoption of a single language could lead to the erosion of cultural diversity, with minority languages and traditions fading away. The process of learning a new language, particularly for older generations, might be arduous and time-consuming. Furthermore, equitable access to language education would be crucial to ensure that everyone has the opportunity to participate in this new linguistic landscape. The potential for social inequality and exclusion could arise if certain groups lack the resources or access to learn the global language. Ultimately, while a single global language has its merits, the potential consequences for cultural diversity and inclusivity cannot be ignored.

## PART 1.1 — Personal questions

🎙️ **Answer the questions about yourself. Speak for about 30 seconds each.**

1. **What do you do on the weekends?**
   ⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s
2. **Do you live in a house or flat?**
   ⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s
3. **What kind of movies do you like?**
   ⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

## PART 1.2 — Compare two pictures

🖼️ **Look at the two pictures and answer the questions.**





4. **What do you see in these pictures?**
   ⏱ 10 s · 🎙 45 s
5. **What are the advantages of family travelling?**
   ⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s
6. **Which types of trip would you prefer?**
   ⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

## PART 2 — Long turn

🗣️ **Look at the picture and talk about the topic. You have 1 minute to prepare and 2 minutes to speak.**



**Talk about:**

- **Describe a time when you shared a secret with others.**
- **Describe the situation that led to sharing the secret.**
- **Mention the people involved in the secret-sharing and the consequences.**

⏱ 1 min · 🎙 2 min

## PART 3 — Discussion

⚖️ **Give a balanced argument for and against the statement, then give your own opinion. 1 minute to prepare, 2 minutes to speak.**

**"Owning a pet has more advantages than disadvantages."**

| FOR | AGAINST |
|---|---|
| Pets can provide companionship and emotional support | Owning a pet means extra expenses |
| Owning a pet can encourage you to be more active | Pets need a lot of attention and care |
| Caring for a pet teaches important life skills | Owning a pet can limit your lifestyle choices |

⏱ 1 min · 🎙 2 min

**1 Part 1.1 What do you do on the weekends?**

My weekends are usually a mix of relaxing activities and catching up on things I don't have time for during the week. I love to spend time with friends, so we often go out for brunch or to see a movie. And, of course, I always make sure to allocate some time for reading, as I find it incredibly relaxing and stimulating. It's important for me to unwind and recharge after a busy week, and my weekends are a perfect opportunity to do just that.

**2 Part 1.1 Do you live in a house or flat?**

I live in a cozy flat in the heart of the city. It's a two-bedroom apartment on the third floor, and I really love the vibrant energy of living close to everything. I enjoy having easy access to shops, restaurants, and cultural events, and being able to walk to most places. Although it's a bit noisy sometimes, I wouldn't trade the convenience and community feel for anything. Plus, having a balcony where I can enjoy a cup of coffee in the morning is a real perk.

**3 Part 1.1 What kind of movies do you like?**

I'm a big fan of movies that really draw me in and make me think. I love well-crafted stories with compelling characters and thought-provoking themes. I'm particularly drawn to independent films and foreign cinema, as they often explore unique perspectives and tackle issues that mainstream movies might shy away from. Of course, I also enjoy a good action movie or comedy when I'm looking for something lighter and more entertaining. But for me, the most satisfying movies are the ones that leave a lasting impression and spark conversations.

**4 Part 1.2 What do you see in these pictures?**

Both pictures compare family travelling and solo travelling. As for the first one, an immediate family, a little daughter with her parents, is in the airport, holding their trip tickets. All of them are excited as the smiles on their faces expose. Family trip is quite fun to have a quality time together, and it also helps make family ties stronger. In contrast, the second picture shows a woman traveling by herself, holding a map of the area. Travelling alone has also advantages, giving travellers a chance of relieving their stress, doing what they want.

**5 Part 1.2 What are the advantages of family travelling?**

Family travel offers a unique set of advantages, primarily the opportunity to strengthen family bonds and create lasting memories. It allows families to experience new cultures together, share adventures, and learn from one another in a way that's not possible in everyday life. It's also a chance to escape the routine and create shared experiences that everyone can cherish for years to come. For example, witnessing the awe in a child's eyes as they see a majestic mountain range or the laughter shared around a campfire during a camping trip creates priceless moments that solidify family connections.

**6 Part 1.2 Which types of trip would you prefer?**

While I enjoy the companionship of others on trips, I find myself drawn to solo travel more often. It allows me to really get to know myself better, to make decisions based solely on my own interests, and to truly appreciate the solitude. There's a certain freedom and independence that comes with exploring a new place on my own terms. I can spend as much time as I want in a museum or wander off the beaten path without feeling pressured to keep up with a group. Of course, sharing adventures with loved ones is also incredibly rewarding, but I find that solo travel provides a unique opportunity for personal growth and self-discovery.

**7 Part 2 Describe a time when you shared a secret with others.**

I'd like to talk about a time when I shared a secret with my close friends. This happened about a year ago when I was planning a surprise birthday party for my best friend, Sarah. I wanted it to be a big surprise, but I realized I couldn't do it alone. So, I decided to share the secret with a few of our mutual friends. The situation started when I found out that Sarah was feeling a bit down because she thought nobody remembered her birthday. I thought it would be a great idea to organize a surprise party to cheer her up. I first talked to my friend Mark and then included two other friends, Lisa and Tom. We all agreed that we wanted to make it special for her. When I shared the secret with them, they were really excited and immediately started brainstorming ideas. However, there was a bit of pressure because we had to keep it a secret from Sarah. We planned everything carefully, from the decorations to the cake, and decided to invite her family and some close friends. The consequences of sharing this secret were mostly positive. We managed to pull off the surprise party successfully, and Sarah was genuinely shocked and thrilled when she walked in. It brought us all closer together as we worked as a team to make it happen. However, there was a moment of panic when one of our friends accidentally mentioned the word "party" in front of Sarah, but luckily she didn't catch on. In the end, sharing the secret not only made the party a success but also strengthened our friendship. It taught me that sometimes sharing a secret can lead to wonderful experiences and that teamwork is really important in making things happen.

**8 Part 3 Owning a pet has more advantages than disadvantages.**

Raising a pet at home has its own certain pros and cons. As for the advantages, pets can provide a sense of companionship and emotional support, especially for people who live alone or have limited social interaction. They can reduce stress and anxiety, offer a sense of purpose and routine, and provide unconditional love and affection. Moreover, owning a pet, especially a dog, encourages a more active lifestyle. Regular walks, playtime, and outdoor activities not only benefit the pet's health but also keep the owner physically fit. This increased activity can lead to better overall health, helping to reduce stress and improve mood. In addition, caring for a pet teaches important life skills such as responsibility, empathy, and patience. Pet owners learn to meet the needs of another living being, which can foster a greater understanding of caring for others. This experience is particularly valuable for children, as it helps them develop nurturing qualities and a sense of accountability. However, owning a pet can be expensive. You need to pay for food, vet bills, grooming, and toys. Some animals, like dogs, require specialized training or daycare, which can add to the costs. This can be a significant financial burden, especially for those on a tight budget. In addition, pets need a lot of attention and care. You need to feed them, walk them, play with them, and take them to the vet. This can be challenging for busy people or those with limited free time. It can also affect your social life, as you may need to decline invitations or rearrange your schedule to accommodate your pet's needs. Another minus side is that owning a pet can limit your lifestyle choices. You might not be able to travel as freely, especially if you're going somewhere that doesn't allow pets. You also might need to make adjustments to your home environment to accommodate your pet, such as installing a pet door or purchasing pet-friendly furniture. This can be a challenge for those who are accustomed to a more flexible and spontaneous lifestyle.

# TEST 29



## PART 1.1 — Personal questions

🎙️ **Answer the questions about yourself. Speak for about 30 seconds each.**

**1** Tell me about your room.
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

**2** Do you often make friends when traveling?
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

**3** Do you have many friends?
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

## PART 1.2 — Compare two pictures

🖼️ **Look at the two pictures and answer the questions.**





**4** What do you see in these pictures?
⏱ 10 s · 🎙 45 s

**5** What are the advantages of doing shopping with friends?
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

**6** Do you usually shop alone or with others?
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

## PART 2 — Long turn

🗣️ **Look at the picture and talk about the topic. You have 1 minute to prepare and 2 minutes to speak.**




**Talk about:**

- Describe a problem you solved.
- What obstacles did you face?
- What did you learn from the experience?

⏱ 1 min · 🎙 2 min

## PART 3 — Discussion

⚖️ **Give a balanced argument for and against the statement, then give your own opinion. 1 minute to prepare, 2 minutes to speak.**

**"Cameras should be required in public areas."**

| FOR | AGAINST |
|---|---|
| The presence of cameras can deter criminal activity | Cameras in public spaces can lead to concerns about privacy |
| Cameras can provide valuable evidence in the event of a crime | Cameras can be misused by those who have access to the footage |
| Increased community trust and transparency | Installing and maintaining surveillance cameras can be expensive |

⏱ 1 min · 🎙 2 min

**1 Part 1.1 Tell me about your room.**

My room is my sanctuary! It's a bit small, but I've made it my own. It's got a comfy bed, a large desk where I do my work, and lots of bookshelves. I like to keep it tidy, but I also have some quirky decorations that make it feel personal.

**2 Part 1.1 Do you often make friends when traveling?**

I've been lucky enough to meet some really interesting people while traveling. It's easier to connect with people when you're both outside your comfort zones and experiencing something new. I usually strike up conversations with locals, and often those turn into friendships. It's a great way to learn about different cultures.

**3 Part 1.1 Do you have many friends?**

I wouldn't say I have a *huge* circle of friends, but I do have a few close friends who I consider to be very important to me. Quality over quantity, you know? We've been friends for a long time, and we share a lot in common. We enjoy doing things together, like going to concerts, trying new restaurants, or just hanging out at home and having deep conversations. Even though we don't see each other every day, I know I can always count on them for support and encouragement. I value the connections I have with them deeply, and that's what truly matters to me.

**4 Part 1.2 What do you see in these pictures?**

The two photos present contrasting scenes of clothing shopping. In the first image, we see a group of three women engaged in a very social and interactive shopping experience. They seem to be helping one another choose an outfit, likely for a special occasion, as they meticulously check the fit, length, and color of the garment. The interaction between them suggests a close-knit friendship, as they offer advice and collaborate on finding the perfect look. The second picture, on the other hand, showcases a solitary shopping experience. A woman is browsing the racks alone, carefully examining the price tags and the quality of the clothing. Her body language conveys a sense of focus and independence, as she makes her choices without external influence.

**5 Part 1.2 What are the advantages of doing shopping with friends?**

Shopping with friends is a really fun way to spend time together. You can bounce ideas off each other, get honest opinions on different styles, and maybe even find some great deals together! Plus, it's always nice to have someone to share the excitement of finding a new outfit with. Sometimes, having a friend's perspective can give you the confidence to try something you might not normally consider, and it can even spark some creative ideas for how to style your new clothes.

**6 Part 1.2 Do you usually shop alone or with others?**

I tend to prefer shopping alone, but I don't mind going with a friend occasionally. When I'm shopping alone, I can browse at my own pace and focus on finding exactly what I'm looking for. I'm not easily influenced by trends or peer pressure, so I can make my own choices without feeling rushed or pressured. However, it's always fun to get a different perspective when shopping with a friend. It's like a mini fashion show! Ultimately, I enjoy both experiences and I think it's important to find the right balance.

**7 Part 2 Describe a problem you solved.**

A few months ago, I had this big problem with my car. It started making this strange rattling noise, and it was getting worse every time I drove it. I was really worried because I needed my car to get to work and for other daily activities. At first, I tried to figure out the problem myself, but I'm not very mechanically inclined, so that didn't work out too well. I even tried searching online for solutions, but I couldn't find anything that matched the specific sound my car was making. One of the biggest obstacles I faced was the sheer lack of knowledge about car mechanics. I had no idea what was causing the problem, and I was afraid of making things worse by trying to fix it myself. I also had to deal with the stress of not knowing how long it would take to get my car fixed and the inconvenience of having to rely on other forms of transportation. Eventually, I decided to take my car to a mechanic. It turned out to be a loose part in the exhaust system, and the mechanic fixed it within a couple of hours. It was a relief to have it fixed, but the experience taught me a valuable lesson about the importance of seeking help when I need it. I realized that I don't have to be an expert in everything, and it's okay to ask for help when I'm struggling with something. This experience also made me appreciate the value of having a reliable car and the convenience it provides. From now on, I'll make sure to get regular maintenance checks for my car, and I won't hesitate to take it to a mechanic if I notice any unusual noises or problems.

**8 Part 3 Cameras should be required in public areas.**

If surveillance cameras are installed in community zones, this can bring up both pros and cons sides. On the one hand, the presence of cameras can deter criminal activity, as potential offenders may think twice before committing a crime if they know they are being monitored. This can lead to a reduction in incidents such as theft, vandalism, and violence, contributing to a safer environment for everyone. And Cameras can provide valuable evidence in the event of a crime. Video footage can help law enforcement identify suspects, understand the sequence of events, and gather crucial information that may not be available through eyewitness accounts alone. This can lead to quicker resolutions of cases and increased accountability. In addition, the implementation of cameras in public areas can foster a sense of security among community members. When people feel that their safety is being prioritized and that there is transparency in public spaces, it can enhance trust in local authorities and law enforcement. This can encourage community engagement and cooperation in maintaining safety and order. On the other hand, the presence of cameras in public spaces can lead to concerns about privacy. Individuals may feel uncomfortable knowing they are constantly being monitored, which can create a sense of surveillance that infringes on personal freedoms and rights. Moreover, cameras can be misused by those who have access to the footage. This could lead to unauthorized surveillance, harassment, or discrimination against certain individuals or groups. There is also the risk of data breaches, where sensitive footage could be accessed and exploited by malicious actors. Another drawback of this, installing and maintaining surveillance cameras can be expensive. This includes the costs of purchasing equipment, installation, ongoing maintenance, and storage of video footage. These funds might be better allocated to other community safety measures or social programs.

# TEST 30



## PART 1.1 — Personal questions

Answer the questions about yourself. Speak for about 30 seconds each.

1. **How much time do you spend on the internet?**
   ⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s
2. **Who is your favorite singer?**
   ⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s
3. **What do you do in the evening?**
   ⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

## PART 1.2 — Compare two pictures

Look at the two pictures and answer the questions.





4. **What do you see in these pictures?**
   ⏱ 10 s · 🎙 45 s
5. **What are the benefits of eating alone?**
   ⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s
6. **What are the benefits of eating with friends?**
   ⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

## PART 2 — Long turn

Look at the picture and talk about the topic. You have 1 minute to prepare and 2 minutes to speak.




**Talk about:**

- Describe a movie that you watched recently.
- When and where did you watch it?
- Did you like it? Why?

⏱ 1 min · 🎙 2 min

## PART 3 — Discussion

Give a balanced argument for and against the statement, then give your own opinion. 1 minute to prepare, 2 minutes to speak.

**"Schools should separate children according to their ability."**

| FOR | AGAINST |
|---|---|
| Students will be less self-conscious about their performance | Negative labelling and limited opportunities |
| Teachers can focus their methods and materials more easily | Reduced social interaction and collaboration |
| Faster learners are not held back by slower ones | Unfairness and inequality |

⏱ 1 min · 🎙 2 min

**1 Part 1.1 How much time do you spend on the internet?**

I spend quite a bit of time on the internet, probably around three to four hours a day. Most of this time is spent on social media, browsing news websites, and sometimes watching videos. I find it useful for staying connected with friends and family, especially since many of them live far away. However, I try to limit my time online in the evenings so that I can focus on other activities like reading or spending time with my family.

**2 Part 1.1 Who is your favorite singer?**

My favorite singer is Ed Sheeran. I really like his music because it has a lot of emotion and tells great stories. His songs are catchy, and I enjoy how he mixes different styles, like pop and folk. I've listened to many of his albums, and I find that his lyrics often resonate with my own experiences. Whenever I feel stressed or need to relax, I put on his music, and it always helps me feel better.

**3 Part 1.1 What do you do in the evening?**

In the evening, I usually have a routine that helps me unwind after a long day. First, I like to have dinner with my family, which is a great time to catch up and talk about our day. After that, I might watch a movie or a TV show for some entertainment. Sometimes, I also read a book or listen to music before going to bed. I think having this time in the evening is important for relaxing and recharging for the next day.

**4 Part 1.2 What do you see in these pictures?**

Both pictures show different lunch experiences. In the first photo, a woman is sitting alone in a cafeteria, looking thoughtful. It seems like she is lost in her own thoughts. In contrast, the second picture shows a group of four women enjoying lunch together, chatting and laughing. This creates a lively and friendly atmosphere. Overall, these images highlight how lunch can be a solitary moment or a time for socializing with friends.

**5 Part 1.2 What are the benefits of eating alone?**

Eating alone can have several benefits. Firstly, it allows for personal reflection and quiet time. When you eat by yourself, you can think about your day or enjoy your meal without distractions. Secondly, eating alone gives you the freedom to choose what you want to eat without considering anyone else's preferences. This means you can try new foods or enjoy your favorite dishes without compromise. Lastly, it can be a good way to recharge, especially for people who feel overwhelmed by social interactions

**6 Part 1.2 What are the benefits of eating with friends?**

Eating with friends has many advantages. One of the main benefits is the social aspect; sharing a meal can strengthen relationships and create lasting memories. When friends gather to eat, they often share stories and laughter, which can improve mood and reduce stress. Additionally, eating together can encourage healthier eating habits, as friends may motivate each other to make better food choices.

**7 Part 2 Describe a movie that you watched recently.**

I recently watched "The Pursuit of Happiness," a film that deeply impacted me. I saw it a few weeks ago at home, streaming it on a quiet Sunday evening. I'd heard about its powerful story, but seeing it firsthand was truly moving. The film follows Chris Gardner, a struggling salesman who is battling homelessness while trying to secure a coveted internship at a prestigious brokerage firm. Will Smith's performance is phenomenal, conveying the immense pressure and emotional toll of his circumstances with heartbreaking realism. What struck me most was the film's unflinching portrayal of poverty and the relentless struggle for self-improvement. Despite facing incredible adversity – including eviction and the constant worry for his young son's well-being – Chris Gardner never gives up hope. His determination and unwavering love for his son are truly inspiring. While it's undoubtedly a difficult watch at times, the film offers a message of hope and resilience that is both uplifting and unforgettable. The emotional weight of the story is balanced by moments of tenderness and humor, making it a truly captivating and emotionally resonant experience. It's a film I'll likely rewatch again sometime soon.

**8 Part 3 Schools should separate children according to their ability.**

There are a number of advantages of dividing students into groups coming from their abilities. When students are grouped with peers of similar abilities, they're more likely to feel a sense of belonging and less self-conscious about their performance. This improved social dynamic fosters greater engagement in learning activities. In addition, Ability grouping allows teachers to adapt their teaching methods and pace to the specific needs and learning styles of each group. Faster learners aren't held back by slower ones, preventing boredom and fostering a sense of accomplishment. Conversely, slower learners receive more focused attention and support, improving their understanding and confidence. This targeted approach maximizes individual progress, ensuring that each student is challenged appropriately and can reach their full potential. Furthermore, Students in higher ability groups are less likely to feel constrained by slower peers, enabling them to progress at their own pace and take intellectual risks, develop critical thinking by doing difficult tasks according to their performance. On the other hand, Putting kids into "high" or "low" groups can create labels that stick. Children in lower groups might feel less confident and believe they can't achieve as much, even if they could. This can limit their chances to learn and grow. Those in higher groups might become complacent, thinking they don't need to try hard. Reduced Social Interaction and Collaboration: Grouping by ability can mean kids only interact with others at a similar level. This misses out on the benefits of learning from and working with people with different strengths and perspectives. It can also create divisions and misunderstandings between groups. Ability grouping doesn't always fairly reflect a child's true potential. Factors like background, teaching quality, and learning styles can affect test scores and placement. This can unfairly disadvantage certain students, making it harder for them to succeed and widening the gap between different groups.

## PART 1.1 — Personal questions

🎙️ **Answer the questions about yourself. Speak for about 30 seconds each.**

1. **What do you do on weekends?**
   ⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s
2. **How often do you watch TV?**
   ⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s
3. **Who is your best friend?**
   ⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

## PART 1.2 — Compare two pictures

🖼️ **Look at the two pictures and answer the questions.**





4. **What do you see in these pictures?**
   ⏱ 10 s · 🎙 45 s
5. **What are the advantages of having salad?**
   ⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s
6. **What are the disadvantages of eating junk food?**
   ⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

## PART 2 — Long turn

🗣️ **Look at the picture and talk about the topic. You have 1 minute to prepare and 2 minutes to speak.**




**Talk about:**

- **Describe a time when you felt happy.**
- **Why is it important to have a good mood?**
- **Can money make people happy?**

⏱ 1 min · 🎙 2 min

## PART 3 — Discussion

⚖️ **Give a balanced argument for and against the statement, then give your own opinion. 1 minute to prepare, 2 minutes to speak.**

**"School days should start later."**

| FOR | AGAINST |
|---|---|
| Improved academic performance | Logistical challenges and disruption |
| Enhanced physical and mental health | Less time for extracurricular activities |
| Increased safety and fewer accidents | Potentially less time for family activities and chores |

⏱ 1 min · 🎙 2 min

## MODEL ANSWERS — C1 model answers · book

**1 Part 1.1 What do you do on weekends?**

On weekends, I usually like to relax and spend time with my family and friends. I often go out for lunch or dinner, and sometimes we watch movies together. I also enjoy doing some outdoor activities, like hiking or biking, especially if the weather is nice. Additionally, I try to catch up on reading or work on personal projects that I don't have time for during the week.

**2** **Part 1.1** **How often do you watch TV?**

I watch TV a few times a week, usually in the evenings after work. I enjoy watching a mix of shows, including dramas and documentaries. Usually, I watch football matches on weekends when I have more free time. However, I try not to spend too much time in front of the screen, as I prefer to engage in other activities like reading or exercising.

**3** **Part 1.1** **Who is your best friend?**

My best friend is Xushnud I've known since high school, and we have a lot in common. We enjoy similar hobbies, like traveling and trying new restaurants. We support each other through good times and bad, and I really appreciate having him in my life. We often meet up on weekends to catch up and have fun together.

**4** **Part 1.2** **What do you see in these pictures?**

In these photos, we can see two different eating experiences. The first photo shows a woman enjoying a healthy salad along with some mineral water. This suggests she is focused on eating nutritious food. In contrast, the second photo features three teenagers sharing traditional hamburgers and having a fun conversation. This indicates a more casual and social dining experience.

**5** **Part 1.2** **What are the advantages of having salad?**

One major advantage of having salads is that they are packed with essential nutrients like vitamins and antioxidants. They also provide a good amount of fiber, which aids in digestion and helps maintain a healthy weight. Additionally, salads are versatile and can be customized with various ingredients to suit different tastes.

**6** **Part 1.2** **What are the disadvantages of eating junk food?**

ne significant disadvantage of eating junk food is its high calorie content combined with low nutritional value. Regular consumption can lead to weight gain and increase the risk of chronic diseases such as diabetes and heart disease. Moreover, junk food often contains high levels of unhealthy fats, sugars, and preservatives, which can negatively impact overall health.

**7** **Part 2** **Describe a time when you felt happy.**

I felt really happy last summer when I went on a trip with my friends to the beach. We spent the whole day swimming, playing volleyball, and just relaxing under the sun. One moment that stands out is when we had a picnic together and laughed a lot over funny stories. The weather was perfect, and we all felt carefree. Being with my friends made me feel connected and joyful and it was one of those days where everything seemed perfect. Having a good mood is important because it affects how we interact with others and handle daily challenges. When we feel happy, we are more likely to be kind and supportive to our friends and family. A good mood also helps us think clearly and make better decisions. For example, when I am in a good mood, I can focus better at work or school, and I am more motivated to achieve my goals. Overall, a positive mood contributes to our well-being and makes life more enjoyable. Money can make people happy to some extent, but it is not the only factor that brings happiness. Having enough money can help meet basic needs like food, shelter, and healthcare, which definitely contributes to overall happiness. However, once those needs are met, other things like relationships, experiences, and personal fulfillment become more important. I think that while money can provide comfort and security, true happiness often comes from meaningful connections with others and doing things that we love.

**8** **Part 3** **School days should start later.**

If school days commence later, this will bring about both some advantages and disadvantages at the same time. On the one hand, later school start times align better with teenagers' natural sleep-wake cycles, leading to increased alertness, concentration, and better cognitive function in class. This translates to improved academic performance, higher test scores, and reduced absenteeism .Another plus side is that adequate sleep is crucial for physical and mental well-being. Later start times allow teenagers to get the necessary sleep, reducing the risk of obesity, depression, anxiety, and other health issues often linked to sleep deprivation. This leads to happier, healthier students, better equipped to learn. Furthermore, teenagers' sleep patterns are biologically different from those of younger children or adults. Sleep-deprived teenagers are more prone to accidents and injuries, whether on the way to school, during school activities, or even at home. Later start times contribute to increased safety by reducing the risk of drowsy driving and other accidents. However, the negative sides of this approach should be also taken into account. First and foremost, shifting school start times requires significant adjustments to school schedules, bus routes, after-school activities, and the work schedules of parents and caregivers. This can lead to logistical difficulties, increased costs, and potential disruption to the daily routines of families and communities. In addition, later school start times may encroach on the time available for extracurricular activities, sports practices, and other enriching pursuits. This can negatively impact students' participation in these activities, potentially limiting their social development and opportunities for personal growth. Finally, with a later school day, the time available for family meals, homework assistance, and household chores might be reduced. This could strain family dynamics and impact students' responsibilities at home, potentially affecting their sense of contribution and responsibility.

# TEST 32



## PART 1.1 — Personal questions

🎙 **Answer the questions about yourself. Speak for about 30 seconds each.**

**1** Do you like flowers?
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

**2** Tell me about your first teacher.
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

**3** What kind of books do you like to read?
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

## PART 1.2 — Compare two pictures

🖼 **Look at the two pictures and answer the questions.**





**4** What do you see in these pictures?
⏱ 10 s · 🎙 45 s

**5** What are the challenges of travelling by plane?
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

**6** What are the benefits of travelling by train?
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

## PART 2 — Long turn

🗣 **Look at the picture and talk about the topic. You have 1 minute to prepare and 2 minutes to speak.**



**Talk about:**

- Describe a time when you had a disagreement with someone.
- When do people usually argue with each other?
- What suggestions can you give to solve disagreements?

⏱ 1 min · 🎙 2 min

## PART 3 — Discussion

⚖ **Give a balanced argument for and against the statement, then give your own opinion. 1 minute to prepare, 2 minutes to speak.**

**"Using the internet should be banned for those under 16."**

| FOR | AGAINST |
|---|---|
| Better protection from online harms | Limited access to educational resources and opportunities |
| Improved focus on education and development | Hindered social and emotional development |
| More parental control and family interaction | Difficulty in preparing for the digital age |

⏱ 1 min · 🎙 2 min

**1 Part 1.1 Do you like flowers?**

Yes, I appreciate flowers. I find them aesthetically pleasing; the variety of colors, shapes, and fragrances is captivating. I especially enjoy seeing them in gardens or wild meadows, where they contribute to the overall beauty of the natural landscape. While I don't have a deep knowledge of botany, I can appreciate their visual appeal and the positive emotions they evoke. However, I wouldn't say I'm a passionate flower enthusiast.

**2 Part 1.1 Tell me about your first teacher.**

My first teacher was a very kind and patient woman named Mrs. Davies. I remember her as having a calming presence and a gentle way of explaining things. She made learning fun through games and creative activities, which was important for a young child. I particularly recall her reading sessions, where she would bring such expressiveness and enthusiasm to the stories that they really came alive. While I don't remember specific lessons, the overall impression I have is one of warmth and encouragement that fostered a positive attitude towards school.

**3 Part 1.1 What kind of books do you like to read?**

I enjoy reading a variety of books, but I have a particular fondness for historical fiction and biographies. I find historical fiction engaging because it immerses me in different time periods and cultures, allowing me to explore history through the lens of compelling narratives. Occasionally, I'll also read contemporary fiction, depending on the author and subject matter. Ultimately, I'm drawn to books that are well-written, thought-provoking, and offer some form of enriching experience.

**4 Part 1.2 What do you see in these pictures?**

In these pictures, we can see two different travel experiences. The first image shows a girl traveling by train. She seems to be enjoying the scenery as she looks out the window, taking in the beauty of her surroundings. This suggests that train travel can be a more relaxed and scenic way to explore new places. On the other hand, the second picture depicts a family boarding a plane. They are carrying hand luggage and appear to be ready for their flight. This contrast highlights how air travel is often faster and more efficient, especially for long distances. However, it might not offer the same kind of connection to the landscape that train travel does. Overall, both modes of transportation have their unique experiences and benefits.

**5 Part 1.2 What are the challenges of travelling by plane?**

Travelling by plane can be quite challenging for several reasons. First, there are the long security checks and waiting times at the airport, which can be quite stressful. Passengers often have to arrive several hours before their flight, making the whole process time-consuming. Additionally, flying can be uncomfortable, especially on long-haul flights, as the seating is often cramped and there's limited legroom. There's also the issue of flight delays or cancellations, which can disrupt travel plans. Lastly, some people experience anxiety or fear of flying, which can make the journey even more difficult.

**6 Part 1.2 What are the benefits of travelling by train?**

Travelling by train has many benefits that make it an appealing option for many people. One of the main advantages is the comfort; trains usually offer more space to move around compared to planes. Passengers can walk around, visit a dining car, or simply enjoy the scenery through large windows. Trains also often have fewer restrictions on luggage, which can make packing easier. Moreover, train stations are usually located in the city center, making it more convenient to reach your final destination. Finally, train travel is often seen as more environmentally friendly than flying, which is an important consideration for many travelers today.

**7 Part 2 Describe a time when you had a disagreement with someone.**

There was a time when I had a disagreement with my friend about which movie to watch. We had planned a movie night, and I wanted to see a comedy, but my friend preferred an action film. At first, we were just joking around about it, but then it turned into a bit of a serious discussion. We both felt strongly about our choices, and it was hard to find common ground. Eventually, we decided to compromise by watching one movie first and then the other later. Looking back, it was a bit silly to argue over a movie, but it taught us the importance of communication and being open to each other's preferences. People usually argue with each other when they have different opinions or interests. This can happen in various situations, like during family discussions about plans or decisions, or even among friends when choosing a place to eat. Arguments can also arise in the workplace over projects or responsibilities. Often, misunderstandings or miscommunications lead to disagreements as well. In general, when emotions run high or when people feel strongly about their beliefs, that's when arguments are most likely to happen. To solve disagreements, I think it's important to communicate openly and listen to each other's viewpoints. One suggestion is to stay calm and avoid raising your voice, as this can escalate the situation. It might also help to find common ground or a compromise that satisfies both parties. Another suggestion is to take a break if things get too heated; sometimes stepping away for a moment can help clear your mind. Finally, showing empathy and trying to understand the other person's feelings can go a long way in resolving conflicts peacefully.

**8 Part 3 Using the internet should be banned for those under 16.**

If those who are under 16 are not allowed to use the internet, this may lead to both some advantages and disadvantages. On the one hand, a ban on internet access for those under 16 would significantly reduce their exposure to harmful online content, including cyberbullying, inappropriate material, and predatory behavior. This would create a safer online environment for young people during a crucial developmental stage where they are particularly vulnerable to manipulation and exploitation. Another plus side is that restricting internet access could encourage a greater focus on traditional learning methods and extracurricular activities. Without the constant distraction of social media and online games, young people might dedicate more time to academic pursuits, physical activity, and social interaction in the real world. Furthermore, a ban would place greater emphasis on parental guidance and family interaction. Parents would play a more direct role in shaping their children's learning experiences and facilitating access to appropriate information. This could foster stronger family bonds and improve communication, providing a better environment for open discussions about appropriate online behavior and the risks of internet usage before responsible access is granted later. However, the negative sides of this approach should be also taken into account. First and foremost, a complete ban on internet access would severely restrict young people's access to a wealth of educational resources available online. This includes online learning platforms, educational videos, research materials, and virtual libraries, all of which can enhance learning and provide opportunities not available through traditional schooling. In addition, the internet plays a crucial role in social interaction for teenagers. Banning access would isolate young people from their peer groups and limit their ability to build and maintain relationships. This could negatively impact their social and emotional development, potentially leading to increased feelings of loneliness, isolation, and difficulty navigating social situations. Finally, the internet is an integral part of modern life. A ban would leave young people unprepared for the demands of a digitally driven world. They would lack the skills and experience necessary to navigate online environments safely and effectively, putting them at a disadvantage in future education, employment, and even everyday life.

# TEST 33



## PART 1.1 — Personal questions

🎙️ **Answer the questions about yourself. Speak for about 30 seconds each.**

**1** Do you live in a flat or a house?
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

**2** What do you usually do to keep fit?
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

**3** Tell me about your favourite drink.
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

## PART 1.2 — Compare two pictures

🖼️ **Look at the two pictures and answer the questions.**





**4** What do you see in these pictures?
⏱ 10 s · 🎙 45 s

**5** What are the disadvantages of playing on the phone too much?
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

**6** What are the advantages of playing outside?
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

## PART 2 — Long turn

🗣️ **Look at the picture and talk about the topic. You have 1 minute to prepare and 2 minutes to speak.**



**Talk about:**

- Describe a time when you tried to do something but failed.
- When was it and what did you try to do?
- Why were you not successful in doing it?

⏱ 1 min · 🎙 2 min

## PART 3 — Discussion

⚖️ **Give a balanced argument for and against the statement, then give your own opinion. 1 minute to prepare, 2 minutes to speak.**

**"All nations need to adopt a single global language."**

| FOR | AGAINST |
|---|---|
| This would eliminate language barriers | This can lead to the erosion of cultures and local languages |
| This can lead to better cultural exchange and understanding | Not all individuals have the same level of access to education |
| No need for translation services and language learning | It would take many years for every country's population to master a global language |

⏱ 1 min · 🎙 2 min

**1 Part 1.1 Do you live in a flat or a house?**

I reside in a flat, actually. It's quite cozy and practical for me. I enjoy having easy access to amenities and the convenience of living in a central location. While I appreciate the spaciousness of a house, I think a flat suits my lifestyle better, especially since I enjoy spending time exploring the city and connecting with friends.

**2 Part 1.1 What do you usually do to keep fit?**

Keeping a healthy lifestyle is important to me. I try to have a balanced diet, focusing on fresh fruits, vegetables, and whole grains. I also prioritize regular exercise, aiming for at least 30 minutes of physical activity most days of the week. I find that a combination of cardio and strength training helps to keep me fit and energized.

**3 Part 1.1 Tell me about your favourite drink.**

Actually, my preference in terms of beverages quite diversifies. It depends on what I am having or what I am doing. When I am having lunch, I prefer to drink hot tea rather than fizzy drinks. In contrast, when I am engaged in physical activities, I would like to have mineral water. Or, on chilly days, drinking hot coffee is my cup of tea.

**4 Part 1.2 What do you see in these pictures?**

The images depict contrasting leisure activities. The first shows a boy engrossed in a digital game on his mobile phone, representative of contemporary screen-based entertainment. This contrasts sharply with the second image, which portrays a boy actively engaged in a physical activity—playing basketball outdoors.

**5 Part 1.2 What are the disadvantages of playing on the phone too much?**

Well, excessive phone use definitely has its downsides. For one, it can seriously impact your eyesight, leading to headaches and even long-term vision problems. Beyond that, it can be incredibly addictive, making it hard to focus on other important things like schoolwork or spending quality time with family and friends. You can also end up feeling quite isolated and missing out on real-life experiences

**6 Part 1.2 What are the advantages of playing outside?**

Playing outdoors offers a wealth of benefits. Firstly, it promotes physical activity, which is crucial for maintaining a healthy weight and cardiovascular system. Beyond the physical aspects, being outside exposes you to fresh air and sunlight, which is good for your vitamin D levels and overall mood. Outdoor play often involves social interaction with friends, fostering teamwork, communication skills, and a sense of community. It allows for more creative and imaginative play, unlike structured screen-based games.

**7 Part 2 Describe a time when you tried to do something but failed.**

I remember vividly the time I first took the IELTS exam. I was aiming for a Band 7 overall, which I knew would open up a lot of opportunities for me. I diligently studied for months, focusing on all four skills - listening, reading, writing, and speaking. I even joined a preparation course and practiced with past exam papers. I felt confident going into the test, but unfortunately, I didn't achieve my desired score. I fell short in the writing section, only scoring a Band 6.5. It was a huge disappointment, and I was disheartened. Analyzing my results, I realized that my biggest weakness was structuring my essays and using more complex vocabulary effectively. I had a good grasp of grammar and sentence structure, but my essays lacked a strong flow and didn't demonstrate a sophisticated use of language. The experience was a valuable lesson for me. I realized that simply studying the material wasn't enough. I needed to develop a more strategic approach, focusing on areas where I struggled. I signed up for additional writing lessons, studied specific vocabulary related to academic writing, and practiced writing different essay types under timed conditions. This time, I focused on developing strong arguments, clear paragraphing, and using a wider range of vocabulary to express my ideas. It wasn't an easy process, but I eventually achieved my goal of a Band 7 overall. This experience taught me the importance of identifying your weaknesses, seeking help where necessary, and putting in the hard work to improve.

**8 Part 3 All nations need to adopt a single global language.**

The idea of adopting a single global language is a compelling one, offering several potential advantages. It would undoubtedly break down communication barriers, fostering smoother collaboration and understanding between individuals and nations. Imagine the efficiency gained in business negotiations, diplomatic talks, and even everyday travel, without the need for translation services. This could also lead to a more unified global community, promoting cultural exchange and reducing misunderstandings. Furthermore, the vast resources currently spent on language learning and translation could be redirected towards other vital areas. However, this seemingly utopian scenario also presents significant challenges. The adoption of a single language could lead to the erosion of cultural diversity, with minority languages and traditions fading away. The process of learning a new language, particularly for older generations, might be arduous and time-consuming. Furthermore, equitable access to language education would be crucial to ensure that everyone has the opportunity to participate in this new linguistic landscape. The potential for social inequality and exclusion could arise if certain groups lack the resources or access to learn the global language. Ultimately, while a single global language has its merits, the potential consequences for cultural diversity and inclusivity cannot be ignored.

# TEST 34



## PART 1.1 — Personal questions

🎙️ **Answer the questions about yourself. Speak for about 30 seconds each.**

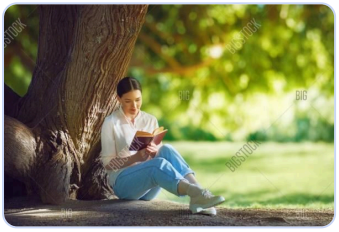
**1** Have you ever purchased anything online?
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

**2** Do you prefer to live in the city or countryside?
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

**3** What do you usually have for breakfast?
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

## PART 1.2 — Compare two pictures

🖼️ **Look at the two pictures and answer the questions.**





**4** What do you see in these pictures?
⏱ 10 s · 🎙 45 s

**5** Which is more relaxing: reading a book or watching a movie?
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

**6** Why do some people prefer reading books?
⏱ 5 s · 🎙 30 s

## PART 2 — Long turn

🗣️ **Look at the picture and talk about the topic. You have 1 minute to prepare and 2 minutes to speak.**



**Talk about:**

- Describe a situation when you forgave someone or were forgiven by someone.
- When should people forgive someone?
- What is the impact of forgiveness on relationships?

⏱ 1 min · 🎙 2 min

## PART 3 — Discussion

⚖️ **Give a balanced argument for and against the statement, then give your own opinion. 1 minute to prepare, 2 minutes to speak.**

> **"All employees should be allowed to work from home permanently."**

| FOR | AGAINST |
|---|---|
| Enhanced employee well-being and productivity | Difficulties in maintaining team cohesion and collaboration |
| Significant cost savings for businesses | Challenges in monitoring productivity and ensuring accountability |
| Access to a broader and more diverse talent pool | Blurred work-life boundaries and increased burnout |

⏱ 1 min · 🎙 2 min

## MODEL ANSWERS — C1 model answers · book

**1** Part 1.1 **Have you ever purchased anything online?**

No, I have never had such shopping experiences yet. This is because online market is not well developed in our country; you have to wait for ages to receive your order. Therefore I prefer to do shopping in markets simply because you can bargain, touch and feel the product you want to purchase.

**2** **Part 1.1** **Do you prefer to live in the city or countryside?**

I would rather urban life for a number of reasons. First, people can have access to better life standards. For example, students can study in top University branches, and people can get better medical treatment. And there are more entertainment options so that people can spend more quality time with their households, and there opportunities for personal growth.

**3** **Part 1.1** **What do you usually have for breakfast?**

It depends on how much time I have. If I am not in a rush, I will often have a big breakfast, such as fried eggs with sausages, jam and cereals, and of course hot tea. When I have little time, I have a light breakfast, which includes only a cup of coffee, that's all.

**4** **Part 1.2** **What do you see in these pictures?**

Both pictures showcase two various spending time experiences. As for the first one, a girl is sitting under the tree and enjoying reading a book. This shows that she prefers to her spare time for educational purposes. In contrast, the second shows close-knit family members, who are indulging in watching a movie together at home. They are sitting in a cozy room which gives cinematic atmosphere.

**5** **Part 1.2** **Which is more relaxing: reading a book or watching a movie?**

For me, watching a movie is far more relaxing than reading a book. Reading often requires a degree of concentration and focus, which can be mentally tiring, especially if the material is complex or demanding. However, watching a movie is a great way to unwind after a long day and switch off completely. The immersive nature of film, with its sights and sounds, makes it a much more effective way for me to de-stress.

**6** **Part 1.2** **Why do some people prefer reading books?**

I think there are several reasons why some people gravitate towards reading books. Firstly, it offers a far greater degree of immersion and active participation. Unlike a movie, where everything is presented visually, readers must actively construct images and emotions in their minds, fostering deeper engagement with the story. Secondly, books allow for a more personal and intimate connection with the narrative. The pace is entirely under the reader's control, and they can re-read passages, reflect on characters, and fully absorb the details at their own leisure.

**7** **Part 2** **Describe a situation when you forgave someone or were forgiven by someone.**

My younger brother once accidentally damaged my phone – a fairly new and expensive model – by dropping it. My initial reaction was a mix of anger and frustration; it was a careless mistake that resulted in a significant financial loss. However, seeing his genuine distress and remorse, I realised that his actions stemmed from clumsiness rather than malice. Ultimately, I forgave him, partly because I valued our sibling bond more than the monetary value of the phone. The experience, though initially upsetting, reinforced the importance of empathy and understanding in family relationships. Forgiveness is a deeply personal choice, not an obligation. It's most appropriate when the offender shows genuine remorse – not just words, but a demonstrable change in behavior – and the context of the offense is considered. Severe, repeated harm might make forgiveness neither possible nor desirable. Ultimately, the decision rests with the wronged individual; it's about their healing, not condoning the act. Forgiveness plays a very important role in relationships. When someone hurts you, holding onto anger can create distance and tension between people. However, when you choose to forgive, it can help heal those wounds. And Forgiveness can strengthen the bond between people. It shows that you care enough to let go of mistakes and focus on the positive aspects of the relationship. Overall, forgiveness can make relationships healthier and more fulfilling.

**8 Part 3 All employees should be allowed to work from home permanently.**

If workers are allowed to continue their work remotely, staying at home, this approach will create both potential benefits and drawbacks. As for plus sides, working from home often leads to improved work-life balance, reducing stress related to commuting and rigid office schedules. This can translate into increased employee morale, higher job satisfaction, and ultimately, greater productivity. Furthermore, reduced commuting costs for employees can indirectly contribute to cost savings. These financial benefits could then be reinvested in other areas of the business, leading to potential growth and improved employee compensation. Finally, removing geographical limitations through a permanent work- from-home policy opens up opportunities to recruit from a much wider talent pool. This allows companies to hire the best candidates, regardless of location, promoting diversity and increasing the chances of finding individuals with unique skills and perspectives. However, potential minus sides should also be taken into account. First, remote work can lead to feelings of isolation among employees, hindering informal communication and spontaneous collaboration that often occurs in a traditional office setting. Another drawback is that supervising remote employees requires different management strategies than those used in a physical office. Accurately measuring individual output and ensuring employees remain accountable for their work can be difficult, requiring a shift in management styles and increased reliance on performance metrics. On top of this, working from home can lead to longer working hours as the boundaries between work and personal life become less defined. Employees may find it difficult to "switch off" at the end of the day, leading to increased stress, burnout, and a negative impact on their overall well-being. This necessitates strong self-discipline and effective time management skills from employees.

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